

2

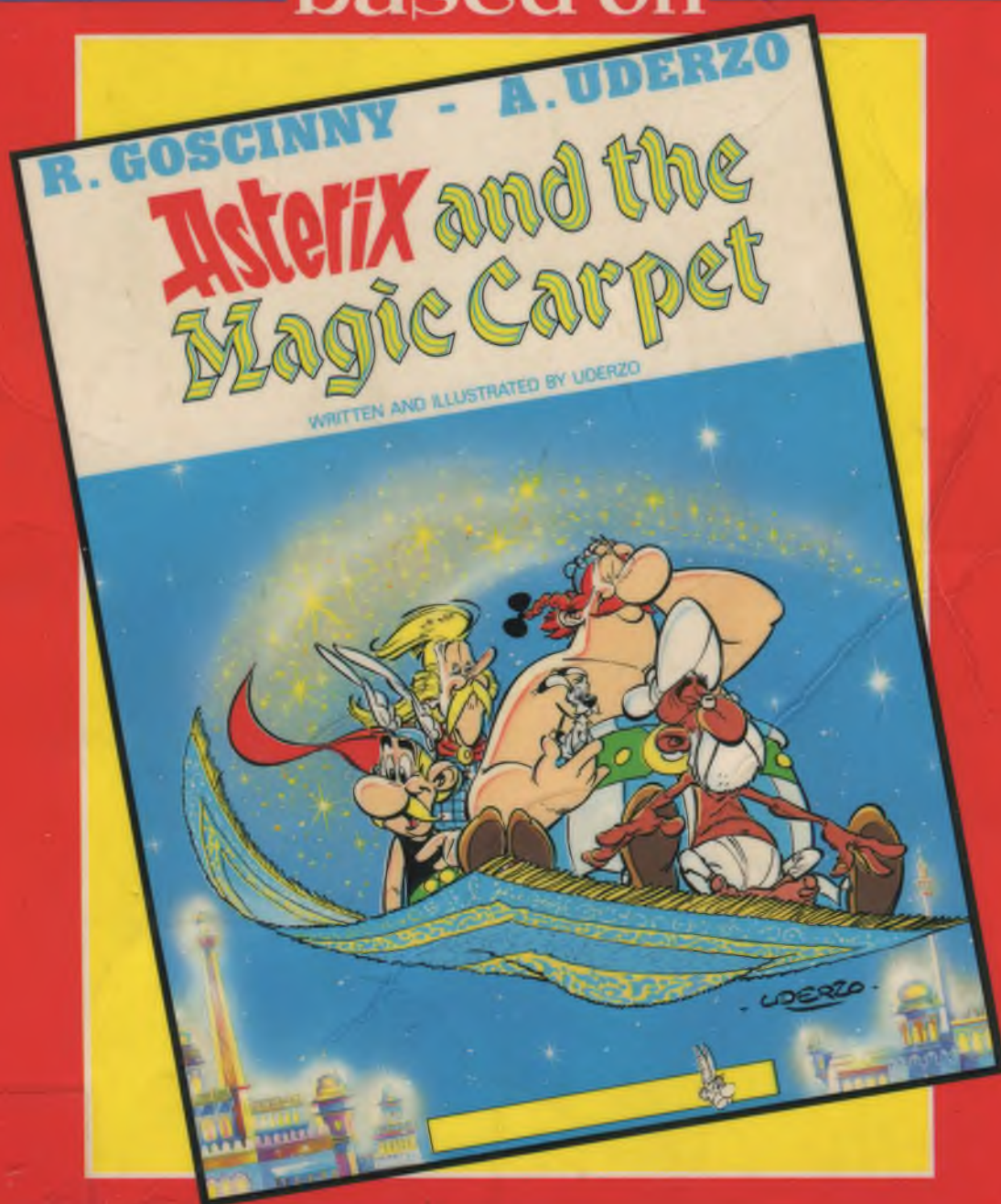
Asterix

and the

2

English Language

—based on—



Christopher Hart

Asterix and the English Language 2

Asterix and The Magic Carpet

Original material written and illustrated by Uderzo
Translated by Anthea Bell and Derek Hockridge

ELT adaptation and original exercises by Christopher Hart



Edward Arnold
A division of Hodder & Stoughton
LONDON MELBOURNE AUCKLAND

INTRODUCTION

This book uses authentic, unedited extracts from **Asterix and The Magic Carpet**. It has been organised to provide practice in reading skills for students of English at intermediate level. It also contains a number of integrated tasks that revise various aspects of vocabulary and grammar, and that provide practice in writing skills. It can be used by students working on their own or by groups.

How to use this book

It is important to follow these points to gain the most from this book:

- 1 Follow the page order.
- 2 Do not use a dictionary.
(There is a word list on page 57, but don't turn to it automatically. Complete the tasks before looking at it. If you are working in a group, discuss the problem areas with your partner first.)
- 3 The tasks are designed to help you. They are **not** a test.
(You will find most of the answers on pages 59–63.)

When you have completed this book, you might like to look at the original **Asterix and The Magic Carpet**. You will find that this book has only used part of the original story.

You might also like to look at **Asterix and the English Language 1: Asterix and Son**, the first book in this series.



Can you put these words into the right order?

- 1 50 BC The is year
- 2 Romans Gaul by the occupied entirely is
- 3 entirely not Well, . . .
- 4 village indomitable invaders out small still of the against One Gauls holds

Here are the main characters of the story.
What do you know about Getafix, Cacophonix and Vitalstatistix?
Write what you know in the empty boxes.

If you are not familiar with these characters, don't worry.
Read the book and note down any information it gives about them.
When you have finished the book, come back to this task.



a few of the Gauls

Asterix, the hero of these adventures. A shrewd, cunning little warrior, all perilous missions are immediately entrusted to him. Asterix gets his superhuman strength from the magic potion brewed by the druid Getafix...



Obelix, Asterix's inseparable friend. A menhir delivery-man by trade, addicted to wild boar. Obelix is always ready to drop everything and go off on a new adventure with Asterix – so long as there's wild boar to eat, and plenty of fighting. His constant companion is Dogmatix, the only known canine ecologist, who howls with despair when a tree is cut down.



Getafix, the venerable village druid.



Cacophonix, the bard.

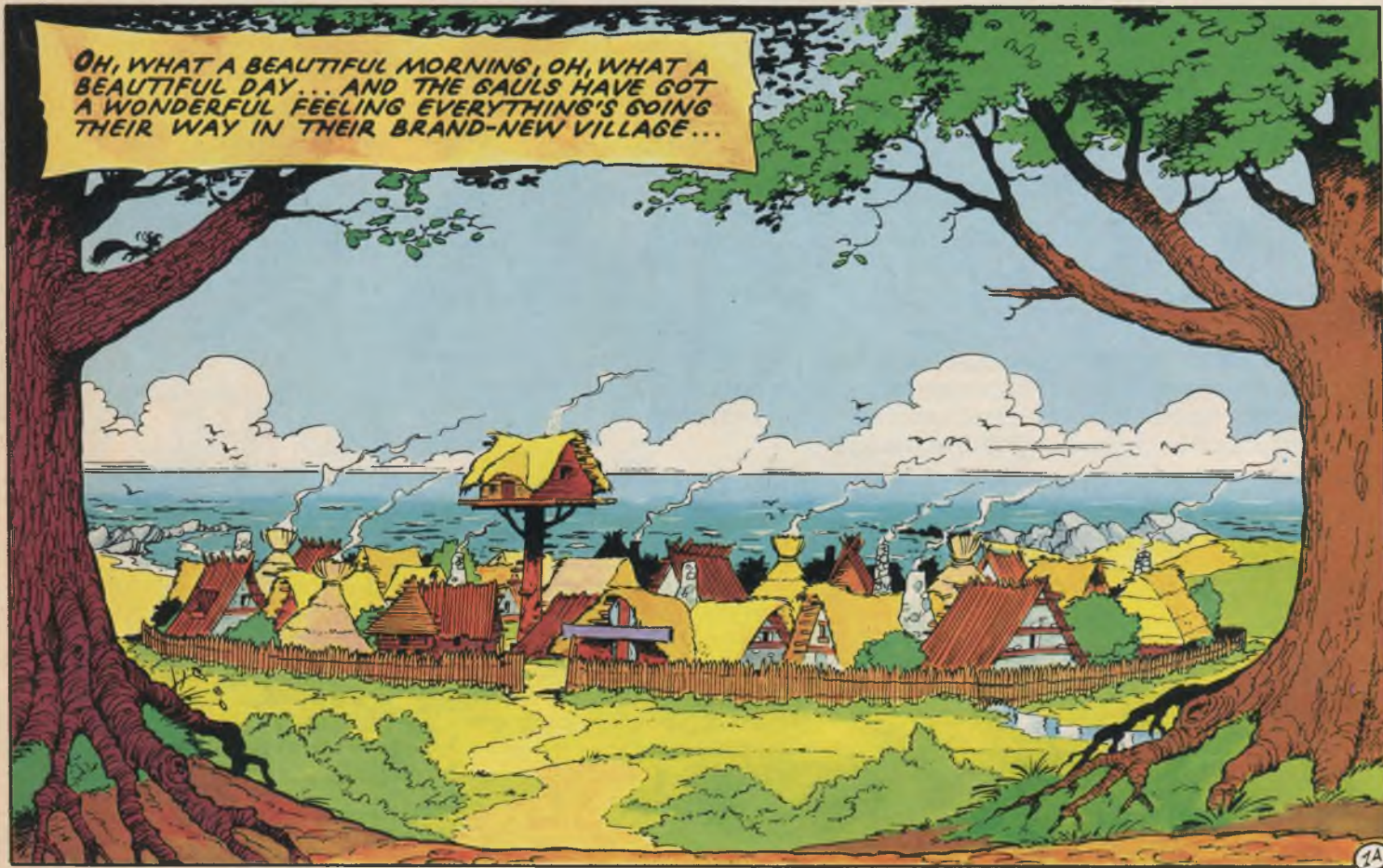


Finally, Vitalstatistix, the chief of the tribe.



SECTION 1

This adventure begins in the village of the Gauls.



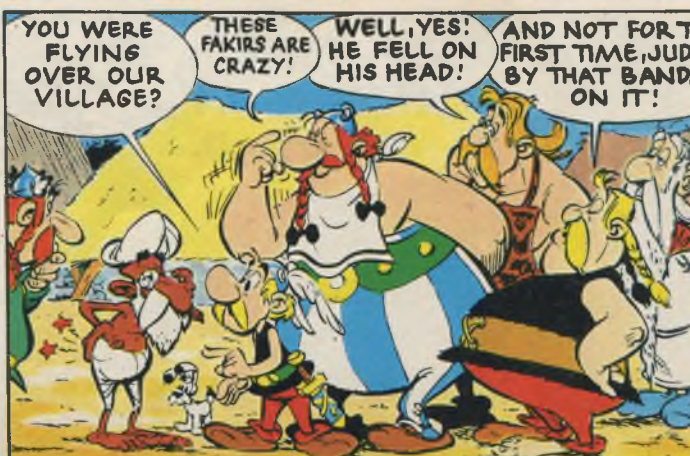
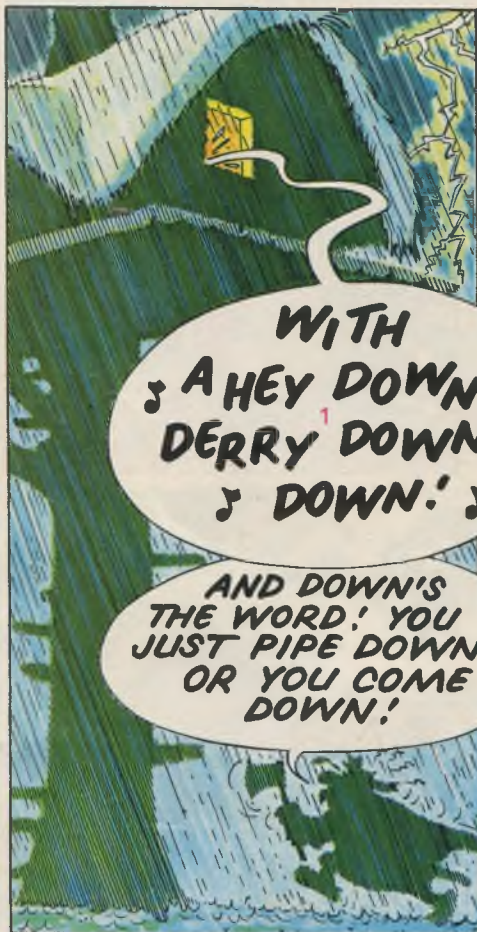
- 1 Look at the houses in the village. How are they different from the houses in your town or village? (size? shape? building materials?)
- 2 One of the houses is built on top of a tree. Who lives there? Why?
- 3 From the title and front cover of this book, what do you think is going to happen in this story?

If you want to know why we begin this story in a 'brand-new village', you should read **Asterix and the English Language 1: Asterix and Son**.

As you read this first extract, see if you can answer these questions:

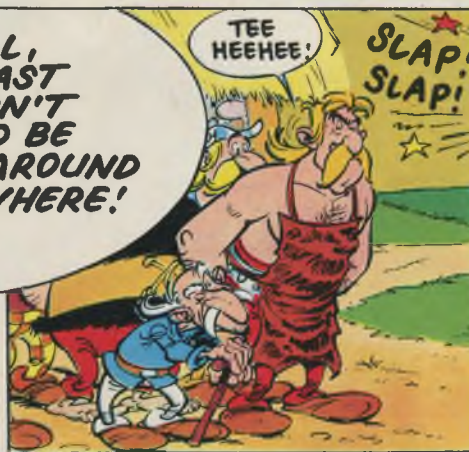
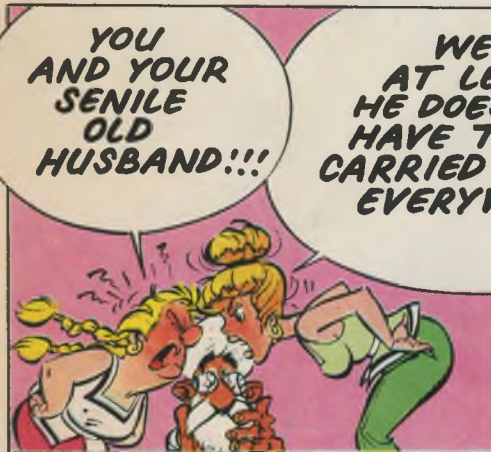
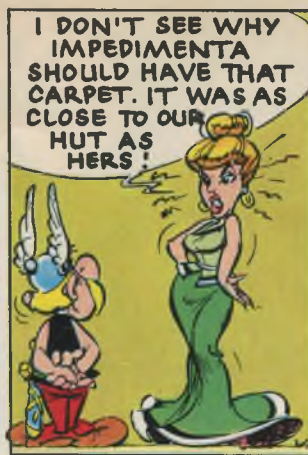
- 1 How many characters are involved in the story?
- 2 Can you name them?

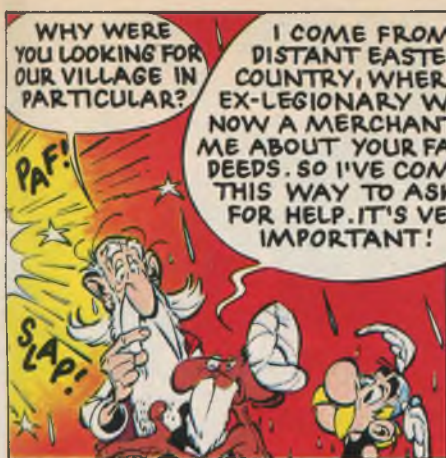
Note: There may be some words or expressions you don't understand. Don't worry about them. The important thing is to complete the tasks **before** using the word lists at the end of the book.



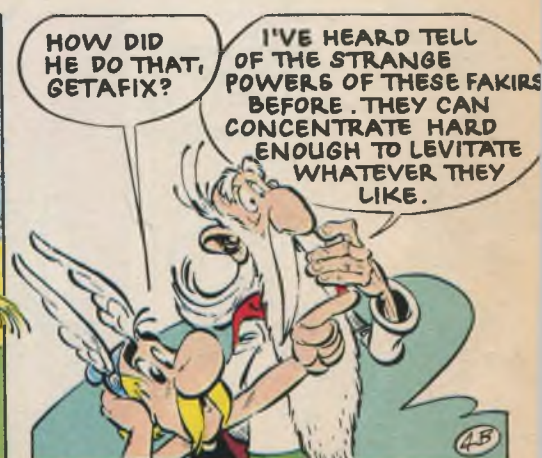
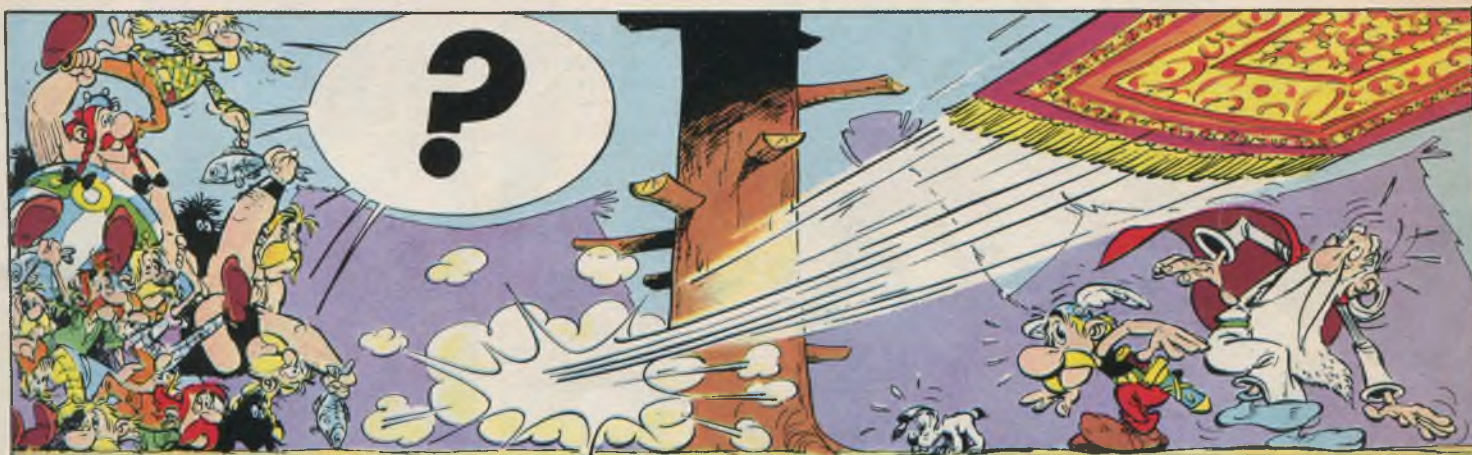
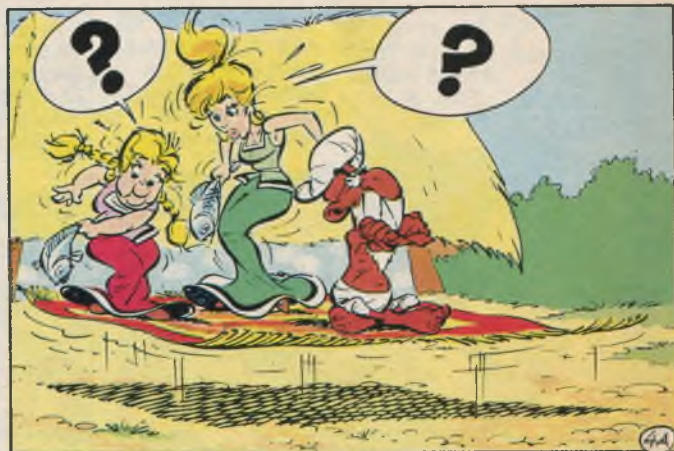
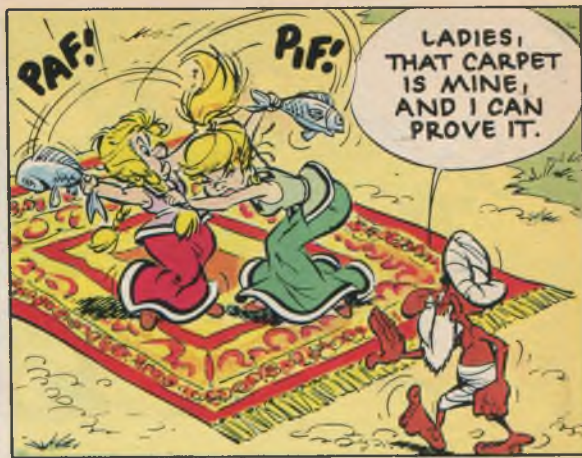
- 1 DERRY a nonsense word
- 2 PIPE DOWN be quiet

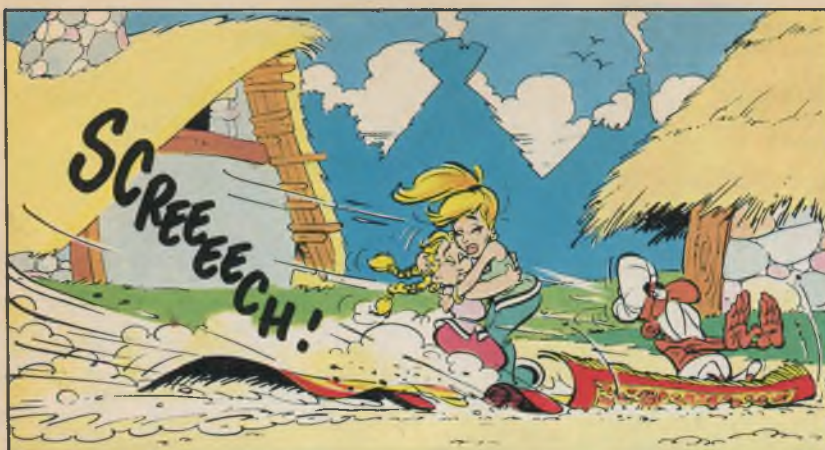
- 3 TOUTATIS a Celtic god
- 4 PIGGYWIGGY a pet name for her husband (suggests he's overweight)





I COME FROM A DISTANT EASTERN COUNTRY, WHERE AN EX-LEGIONARY WHO IS NOW A MERCHANT TOLD ME ABOUT YOUR FAMOUS DEEDS. SO I'VE COME ALL THIS WAY TO ASK YOU FOR HELP. IT'S VERY IMPORTANT!





Further comprehension

- 1 Why is Cacophonix singing?
- 2 Does Vitalstatistix like his singing?
- 3 What strange effect does his singing have?
- 4 Who is Impedimenta?
- 5 Why does she have a fight with the other woman?
- 6 Why does the little old man start another fight?
- 7 Who is Watziznehm? What do you know about him?
- 8 Is he happy to be in the Gaulish village?
- 9 What do you think he wants?
- 10 There are probably a number of words and expressions you don't know. **Without** looking at your dictionary or at the word list at the back of this book, see if you can work out the meaning of the following words:



a FETCH

- (i) cook
- (ii) sell
- (iii) bring



b BUDGE

- (i) speak
- (ii) move
- (iii) joke



c STOUT

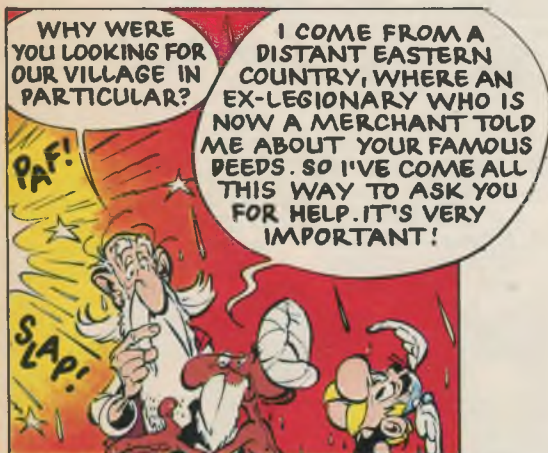
- (i) stupid
- (ii) fat
- (iii) friendly

Who/How/Why

1 **WHO/HOW/WHY** can be used to form questions.
Can you think of any more words like these?

2 Look at these examples of **WHY** taken from the passage you have just read. How are they different grammatically?

a

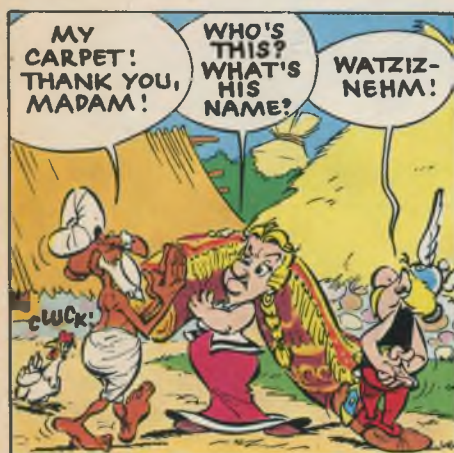


b



Now do the same for these two examples of **WHAT** :

c



d



3 Look at pages 7–10 again and find examples of **WHEN, WHY WHERE** and **WHO** being used like **b** and **d** above.

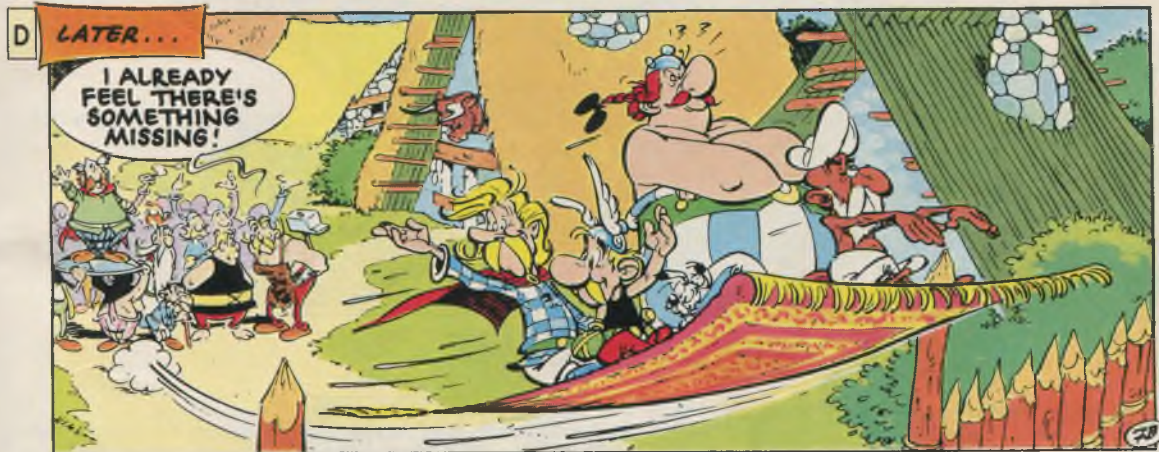
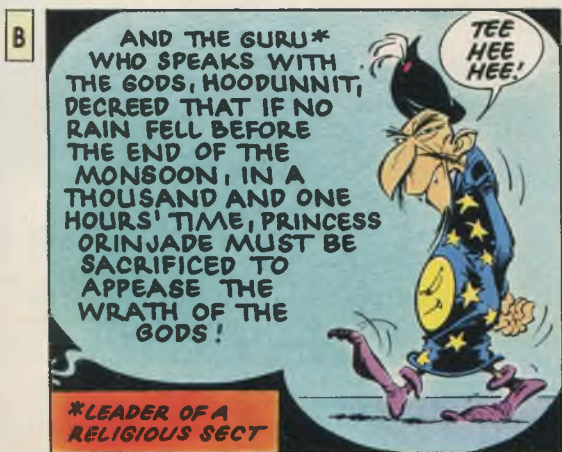
4 Can you complete these sentences? The first one has been done for you.

- a Cacophonix knows how . . . (make/rain) **Cacophonix knows how to make it rain.**
- b Asterix doesn't understand how . . . (fakir/fly)
- c Obelix gets upset when . . . (fakir/suggest/fat)
- d The Gauls want to know why . . . (fakir/come/village)

Here is the next part of the story.

Put the cartoons in the right order and then answer these questions:

- 1 What is Watziznehm's problem?
- 2 How can the Gauls help?



Apostrophes

The apostrophe has two basic uses in English:

- 1 For contractions, e.g.

I AM — I'M

- 2 For possessives, e.g.

THE WIFE OF THE CHIEF
— THE CHIEF'S WIFE



Contractions

- 1 Contractions are a feature of spoken English (and are becoming more common in written English).

How many examples can you find on pages 7–10?

- 2 Sometimes, however, the contracted form may carry a different meaning from the full form.

Look at 'LL in this cartoon.

Does it express:

- a an order?
- b an offer to help?
- c a prediction?

Now look at WILL.

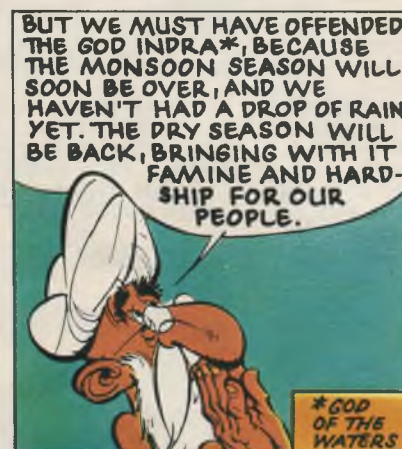
Does it express:

- a an order?
- b an offer to help?
- c a prediction?



- 3 What is the meaning of WILL in this example?

Is it the same as 2 above?



Possessives

- 1 The possessive 'S is used when talking about people (e.g. the chief's wife, where the chief is a person).
When talking about things **OF** is used. For example:



- 2 **TIME** is a major exception to this 'rule'.

e.g. after one day → in one day's time
after one month → in one month's time

- 3 Look at this cartoon. What do you notice about the apostrophe?

- 4 Now complete these examples:

after two days → in two . . .
after five years
after an hour
after a few moments



- 5 Now look at these cartoons. What do you notice about the possessive?

- 6 Now complete these:

That is my carpet
→ That carpet is mine

That is your carpet
That is our carpet
That is their carpet
That is her carpet
That is his carpet



Modals

Look at these cartoons again. They each contain an example of a modal verb. Can you fill the gaps with the words in the box?

CAN	WOULD	COULD	WOULD	COULD
			WOULD	COULD



*LEADER OF A RELIGIOUS SECT

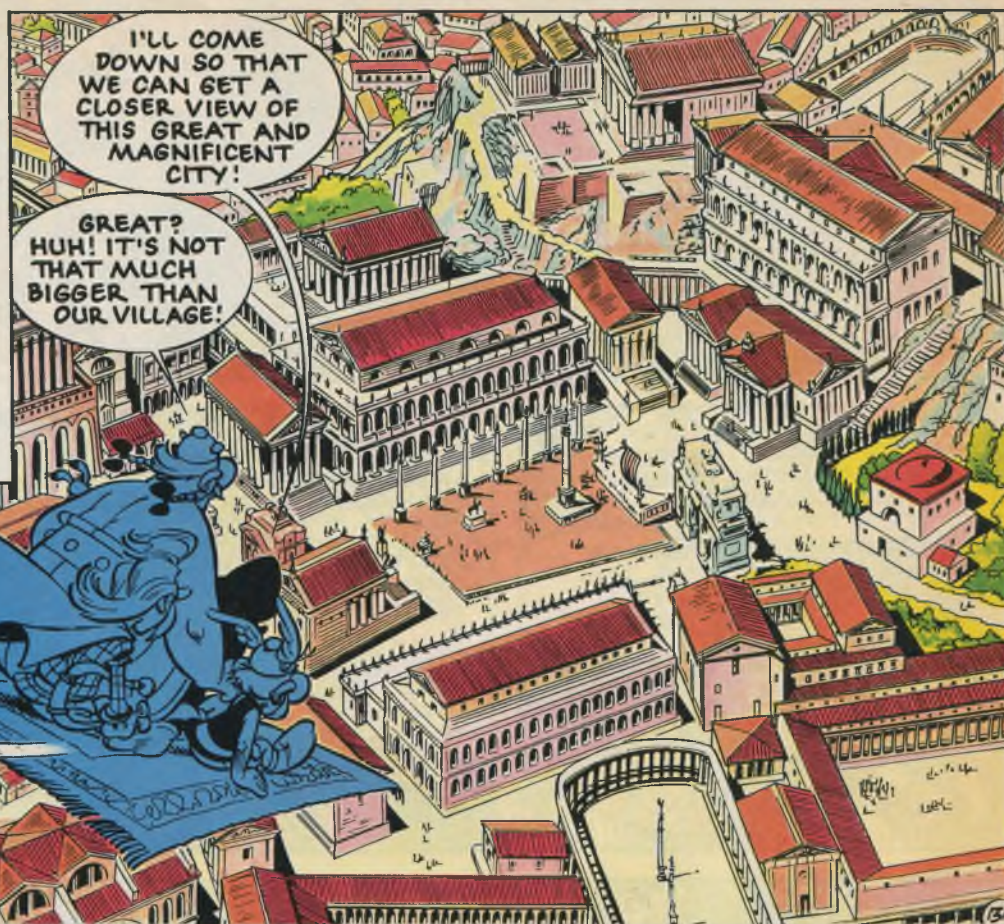


SECTION 2

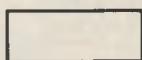
Our heroes see many things on their way to India.

Look at these cartoons:

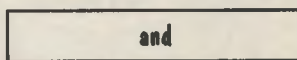
- 1 What city are they flying over?
- 2 From memory, can you complete the missing colours?



the carpet

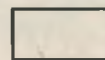


Cacophonix's
cloak



and

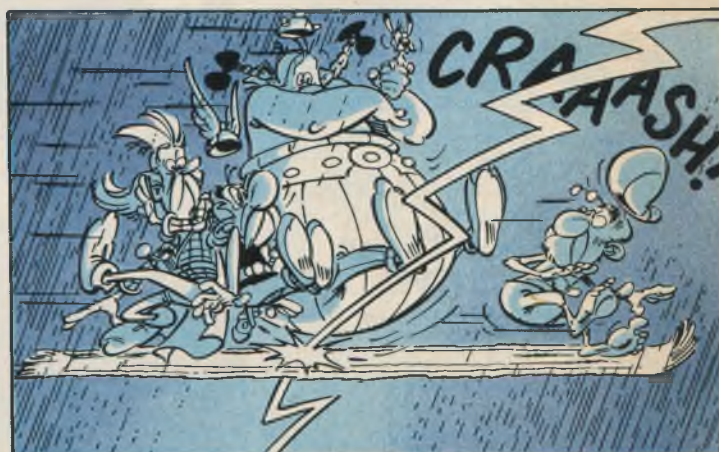
Obelix's trousers

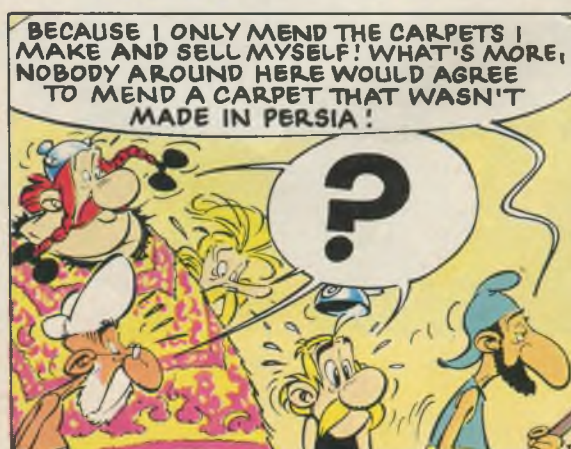
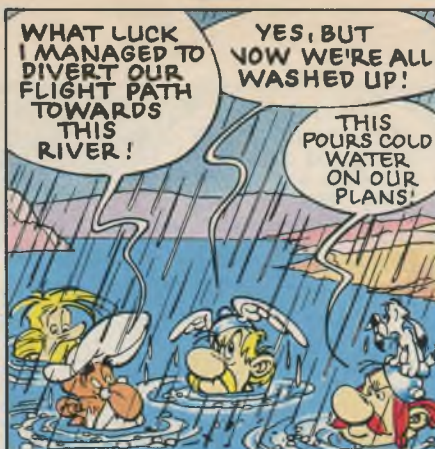


Asterix's
top

In the next extract, our heroes are struck by lightning and are forced to crash-land.
As you read, see if you can answer these questions:

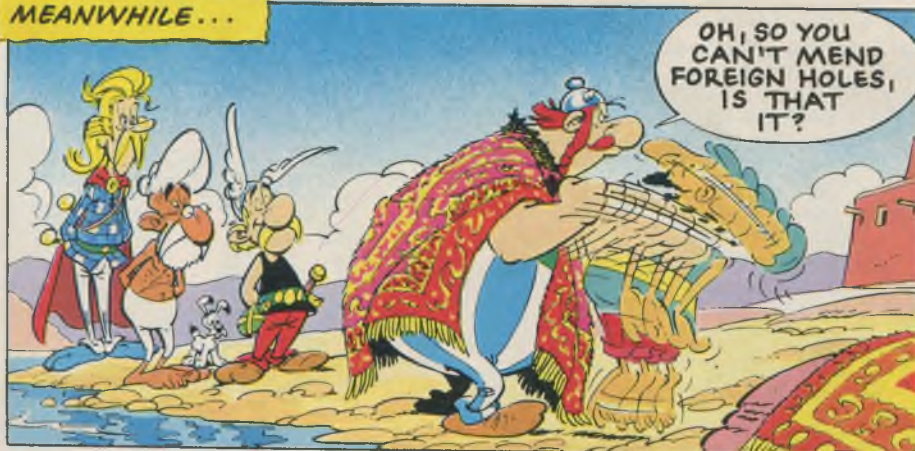
- 1 Our heroes have a problem.
What is it?
- 2 Why do the Persians agree to help?







MEANWHILE...





**THE PIRATES
WILL STEAL OUR
CARPETS AND BURN
OUR HOUSES DOWN
AGAIN!!!**



I BEG YOU! IF
YOU HAVE ANY POWERS,
HELP US TO MEND
MATTERS, OR IT WILL
BE THE END OF OUR
VILLAGE!!!

SORRY,
CAN'T BE
DONE!



WHY
NOT?

BECAUSE YOUR
PROBLEMS ARE
FOREIGN TO US, AND
WE DON'T HAVE THE
NECESSARY SPARE
PART EITHER!



WHAT'S
THAT?

A
CARPET!



TAKE THIS
ONE, BY AHURA
MAZDA*

DONE, BY
TOUTATIS!



***GOD OF THE
ANCIENT PERSIANS.**

CACOFONIX,
YOU WAIT HERE
WITH DOGMATIX.
THIS WON'T
TAKE LONG!

A BIT OF
ACTION AT
LAST!



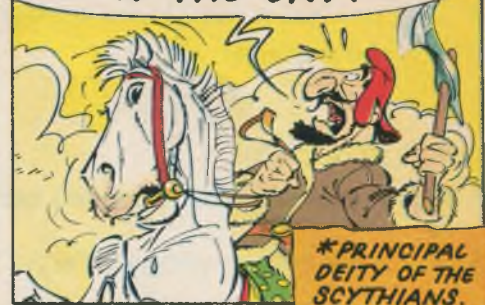
WATZIZNEHM,
CAN YOU FLY
THROUGH THE
RANKS OF THE
SCYTHIANS
QUITE LOW?

PLANNING
TO SCYTHE
THROUGH
THEM?





BY THE GREAT
GODDESS*! WE MUST FLY
FROM THESE DEMONS
OF THE SKY!



Further comprehension

- 1 Can you find two words on page 18 that mean the same as carpet?
- 2 Can you find a word in the extract that means the same as:
 - a make a carpet _ _ _ _ V E
 - b repair _ _ _ _ D
 - c in addition to _ _ S _ _ _ S
 - d the raised part on a camel's back _ _ _ _ P
- 3 How is the Persian village different from the Gaulish village?
Why is it different?
- 4 **Without** looking back at the text, can you remember:
 - a what the Persian carpet weaver is wearing (colours?)?
 - b how many carpets he is washing?



- 5 Where do the Scythians come from?
- 6 Can you name:
 - a a Persian god?
 - b a Gaulish god?

Prepositions

Look at these cartoons.
Can you fill the gaps with the
words in the box?

TOWARDS	AROUND
OVER	ALONG
FROM	

A

THAT'S POSSIBLE... IN
FACT, WE MAY HAVE
FALLEN ON OUR FEET,
LANDING HERE! PERSIA
IS FAMOUS FOR ITS
CARPETS. IF WE GO ON
THIS RIVER, WE
MIGHT FIND A CARPET
MENDER.



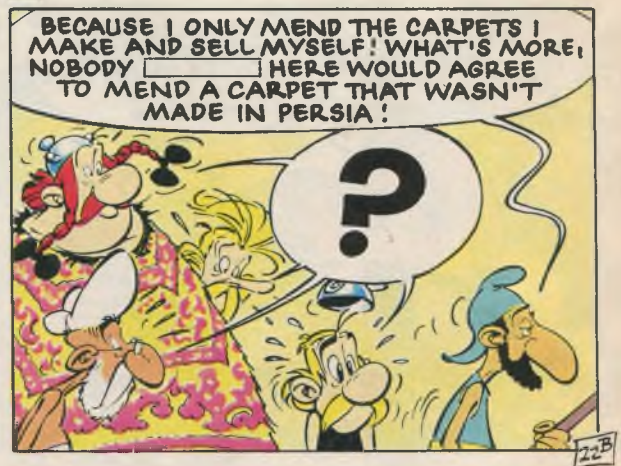
B



C

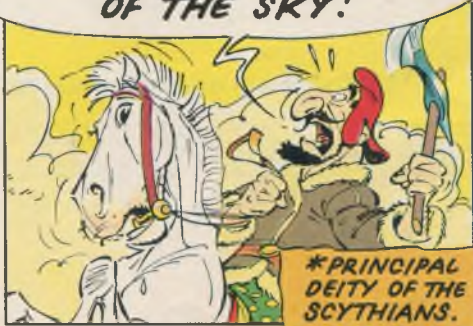


D



E

BY THE GREAT
GODDESS*! WE MUST FLY
THESE DEMONS
OF THE SKY!



WILL

- 1 We have seen on page 14 that **WILL** can be used to express:
- a an order.
 - b a prediction.

Which meaning is being used here?



- 2 If you contract **WILL** to '**LL**' in this example, does the meaning change?

- 3 Now look at what the Persian is saying in this cartoon:



Which of the following best explains the meaning of '**LL**' here?

- a make an offer.
- b make a prediction.
- c make a spontaneous decision.

Passives

- 1 Look at these two sentences and decide which is **active** and which is **passive**.

- a **Asterix and the Magic Carpet** was written and illustrated by Uderzo.
- b Uderzo wrote and illustrated **Asterix and the Magic Carpet**.

- 2 Read this again and underline any examples of the passive you can find:

The year is 50 BC. Gaul is entirely occupied by the Romans. Well, not entirely . . . One small village of indomitable Gauls still holds out against the invaders. And life is not easy for the Roman legionaries who garrison the fortified camps of Totorum, Aquarium, Laudanum and Compendium

- 3 Here is the structure of the above examples of the passive:

BE	+	PAST PARTICIPLE	(+ BY)
was		written	by
is		occupied	by

- 4 Here is another example of the passive.
How is it different from those above?



Can you complete the structure?

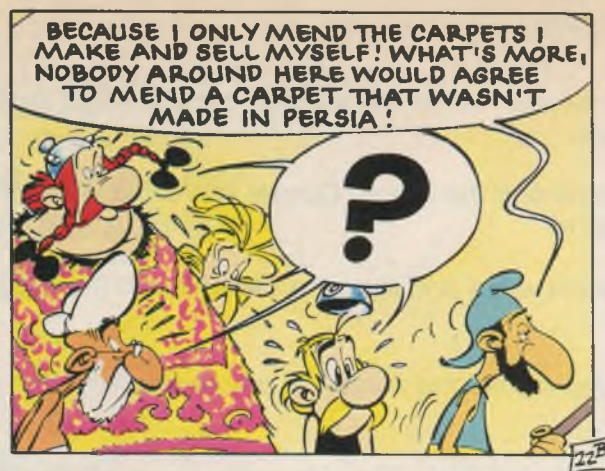
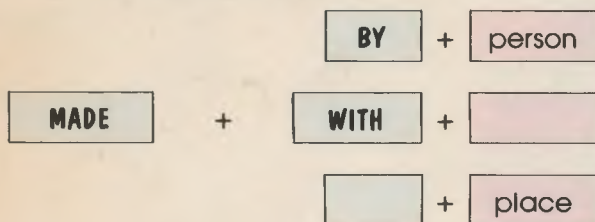
(+) **BE** + **PAST PARTICIPLE** + (+ **BY**)

5 Now look at this cartoon.

a Underline the passive.

b How is the structure different from the examples above?

6 Can you complete this diagram?



7 Compare these two cartoons.

Why does the Persian use the passive in **A** but the active in **B**?



8 Certain verbs often appear in the passive e.g. **WAS MADE IN**.

Can you think of any other examples?

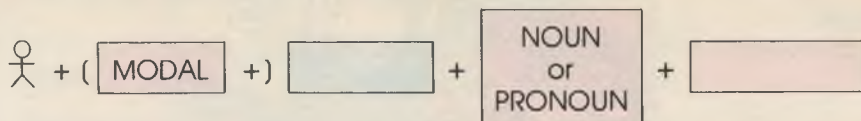
9 Passives are often found in newspaper reports. Imagine you are a reporter for the Gaulish Gazette.

Here is your headline. Can you complete the article?

CARPET HIT BY LIGHTNING
A Ganges Airlines flying carpet was forced to make an emergency landing in Persia yesterday afternoon. The carpet, with three Gauls aboard, . . .

10 Here is another example of a passive.

- a How is it different from the ones we have been looking at?
- b Can you complete the structure?



- c Which of the following verbs could replace **GET** in this structure?
 (i) **BE** (ii) **HAVE** (iii) **GO**

- d When do you use this type of passive?
 (i) When you don't know who is going to do the action.
 (ii) When you want to pay for a service.
 (iii) When you want someone else to do the action for you.



11 Here are some examples of how to use the structure above. Can you complete them?

- a **OUR HEROES/NEW CARPET/GIVE/TO THEM** Our heroes had
got a new carpet given to them.
- b **THE GRATEFUL PERSIANS ALSO/BANQUET/PREPARE.**
- c **HOWEVER, HOODUNNIT/PLAN TO/PRINCESS ORINJADE/EXECUTE.**

12 Look at these two cartoons.



BE WASHED UP and **BE DONE FOR** have the same meaning here.

Is it:

- a clean? b exhausted/very tired? c finished/this is the end?

Should have

Look at the fakir's words in this cartoon.

- 1 a Did he bring a spare carpet?
b Is he happy not to have a spare carpet?
c How then does he feel?

- 2 **SHOULD HAVE** + **PAST PARTICIPLE** is used to express:

- a surprise
- b regret/criticism
- c obligation

3 I SHOULD HAVE BROUGHT . . .

How would you contract **SHOULD HAVE** ?

- 4 In book 1 of this series (**Asterix and Son**), we saw how to use the present tense of:

MUST BE

CAN'T BE

MAY BE

- a From the structure in 2 above, what do you think is the past tense?

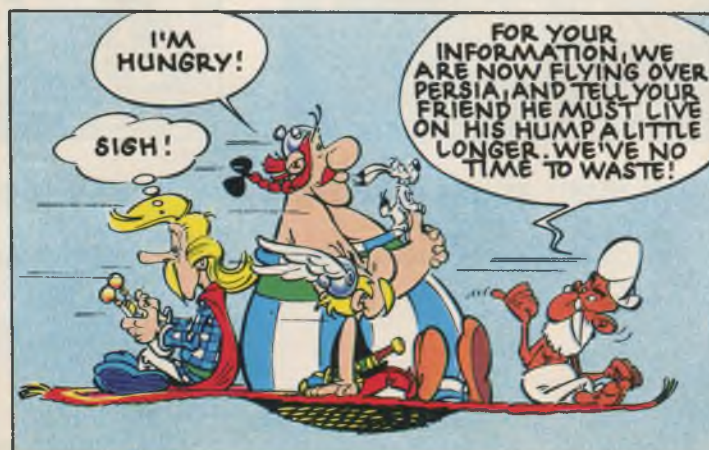
(i) **MUST** + **HAD** + **PAST PARTICIPLE**

(ii) **MUST** + **HAVE** + **PAST PARTICIPLE**

(iii) **DID** + **MUST** + **PAST PARTICIPLE**

- b Can you find an example in the passage you have just read? (pages 18–21)
- c In the next extract (pages 32–35) you will find two more examples.

- 5 Watziznehm feels he should have brought along a spare carpet. Obelix has a different criticism. Look at this cartoon and read page 10 again. What is his criticism?



Summary

Here is a summary of the story so far.

1 Put these sentences into the right order:

- a Chief Vitalstatistix gave his permission for Cacophonix, Asterix and Obelix to set off for India on board a flying carpet.
- b They didn't have much time to lose.
- c Our heroes were able to help the Persians defeat their enemies, the Scythians.
- d One day, the Gauls were visited by a fakir from India, where it hadn't rained for a year.
- e They were flying over Persia.
- f He had magic powers.
- g They were very excited about their new adventure.
- h They were struck by lightning.
- i In exchange, the Persians gave them a new carpet and roast camel with caviar.
- j He wasn't able to make it rain.
- k They were forced to crash-land.

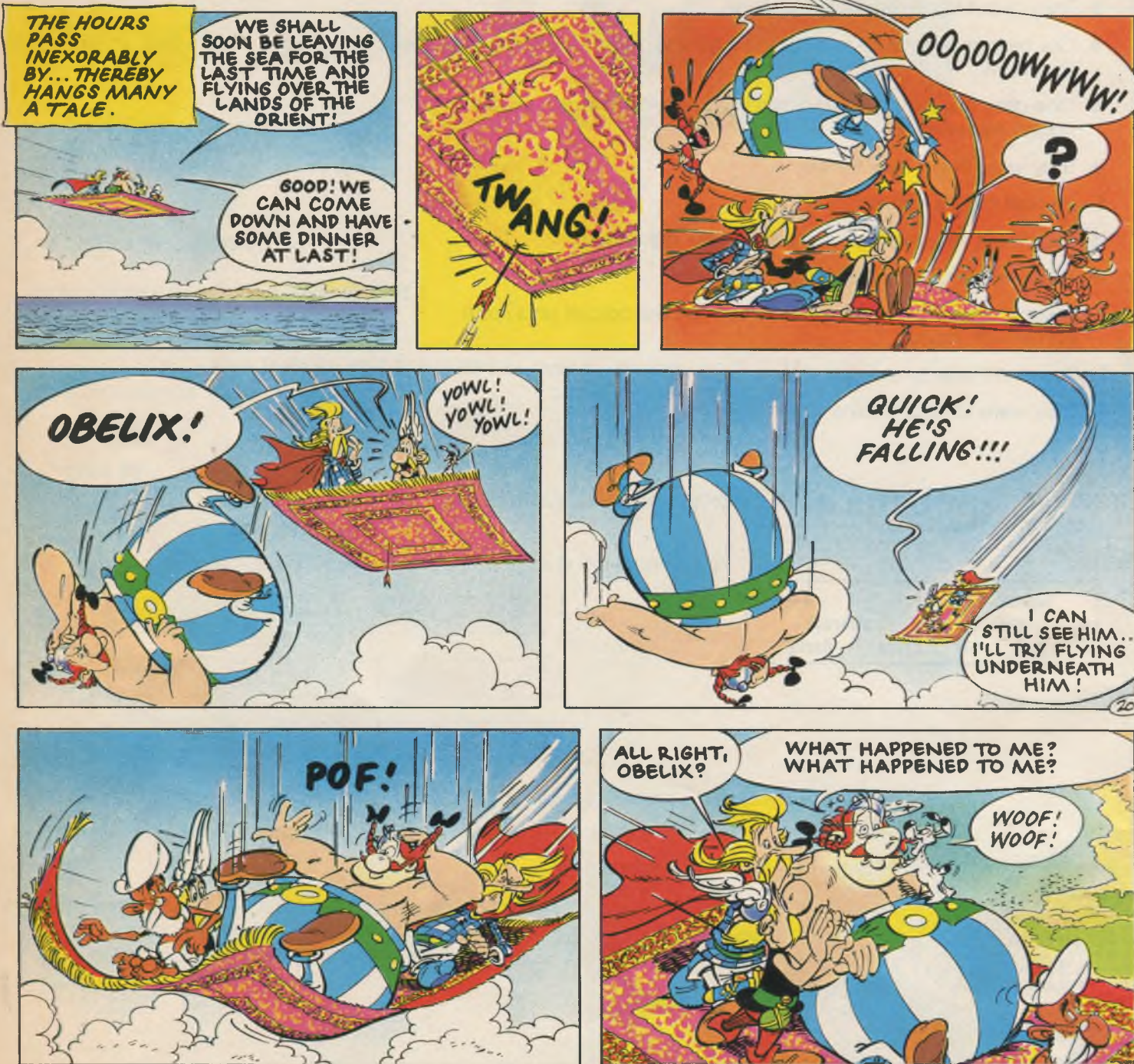
2 Now rewrite these sentences into a paragraph, using some of the words in the box below:

however	while	so	next
still	when	although	
too	but	then	finally

3 Here is another episode in the adventure.

It takes place as they fly over Tyre, a Phoenician port in the Eastern Mediterranean.

Write a short paragraph describing what happens (using some of the words from 2).



Here are some words you might find useful:

ARROW (= )

IN A STATE OF SHOCK

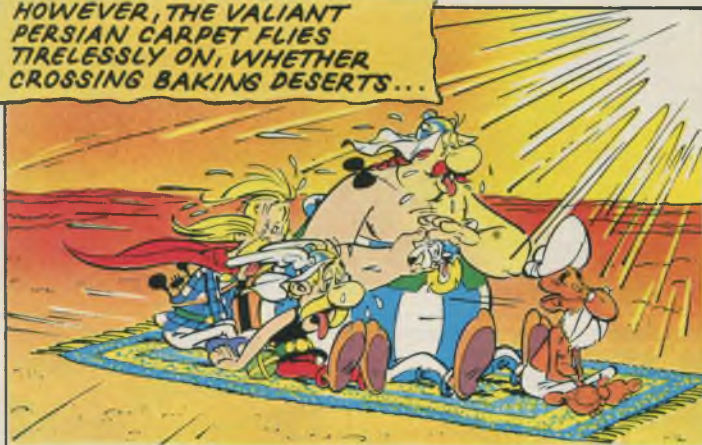
HOWL (= a dog crying)



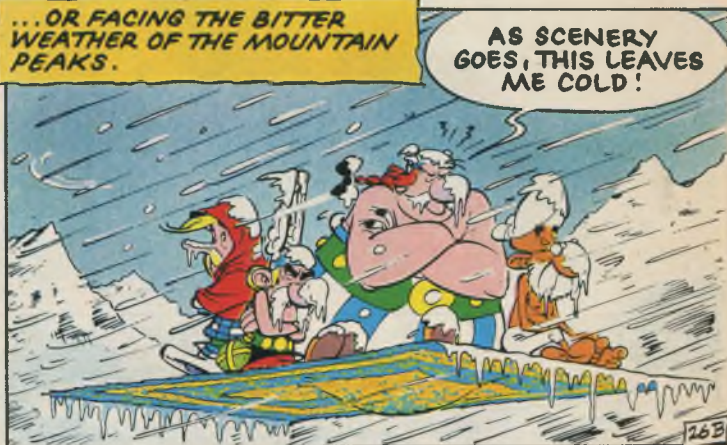
SECTION 3

Our heroes cross many lands and have many adventures . . .

**HOWEVER, THE VALIANT
PERSIAN CARPET FLIES
TIRELESSLY ON, WHETHER
CROSSING BAKING DESERTS...**



**... OR FACING THE BITTER
WEATHER OF THE MOUNTAIN
PEAKS.**



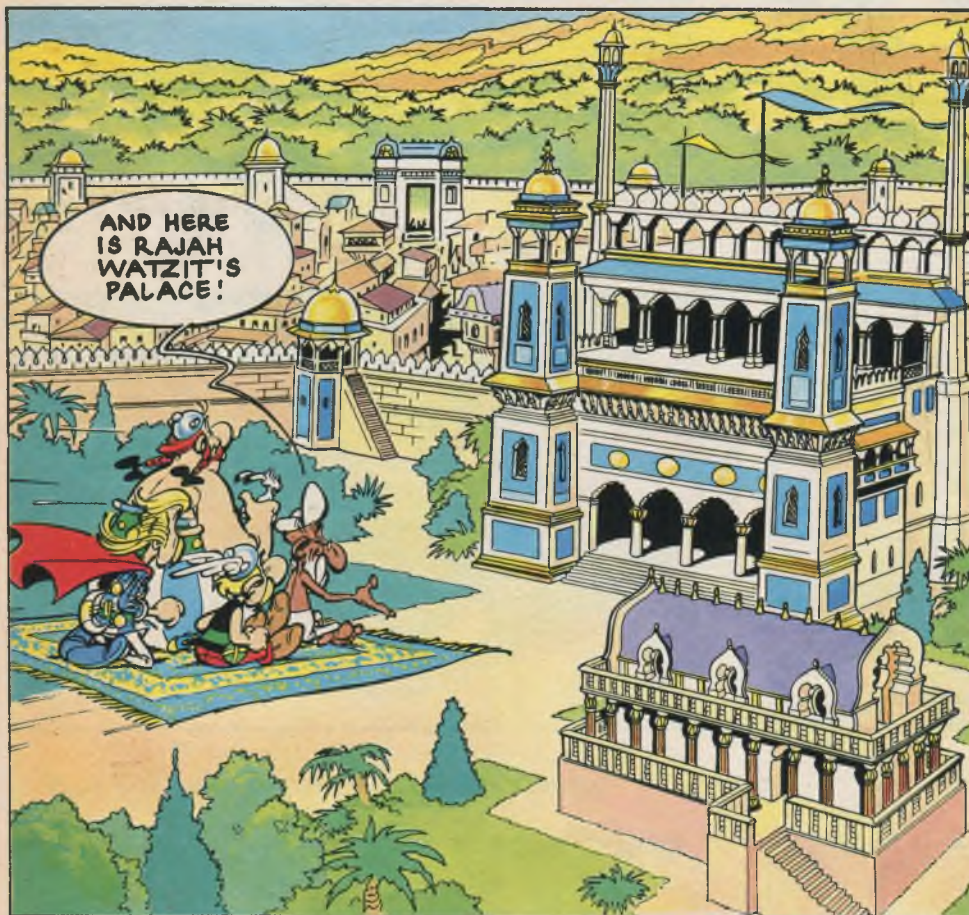
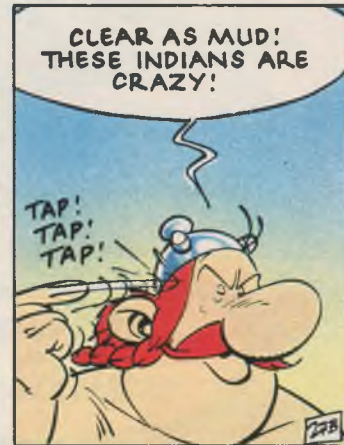
. . . before arriving at the valley of the River Ganges.

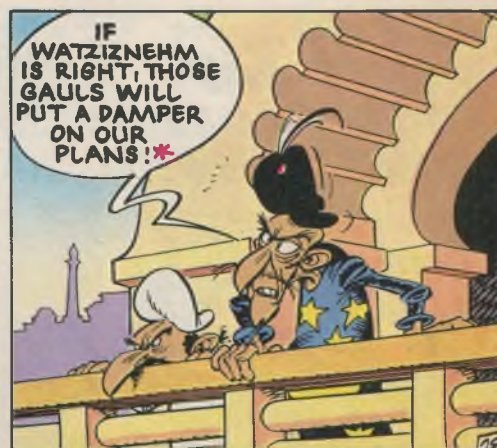
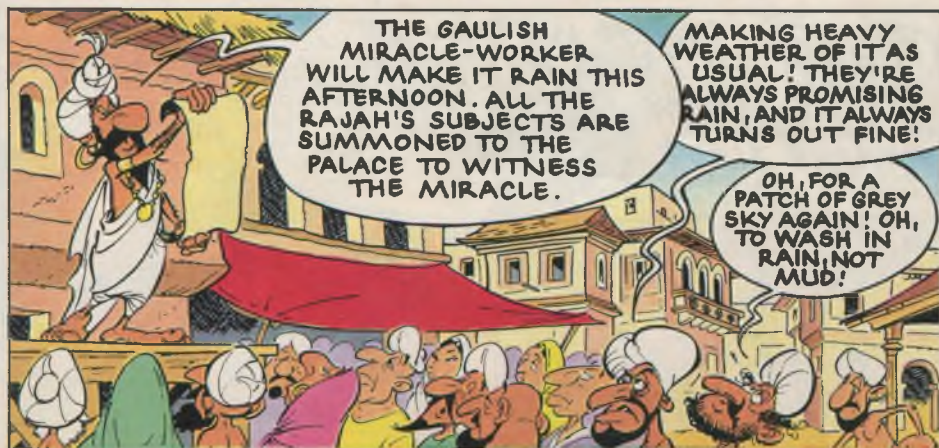
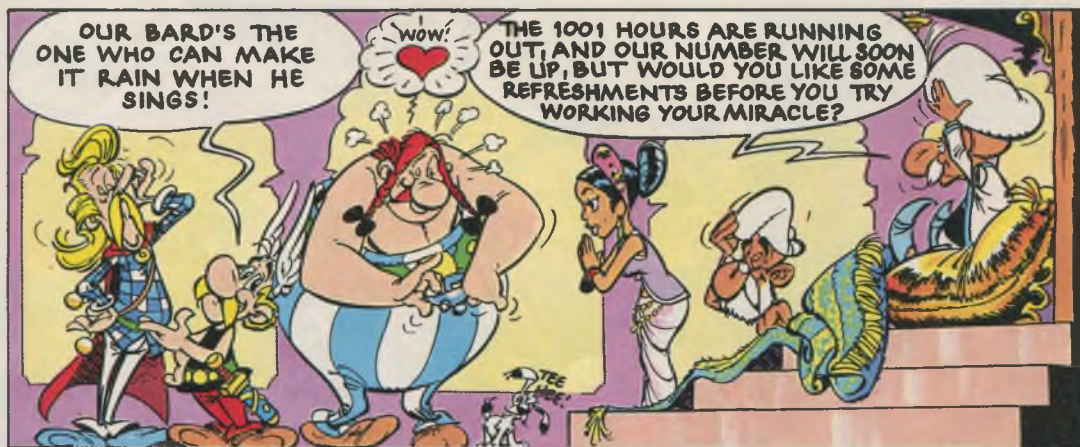
As you read the next extract, see if you can answer these questions:

- 1 How much more time does Princess Orinjade have before she will be sacrificed?
- 2 What has happened to Cacofonix?

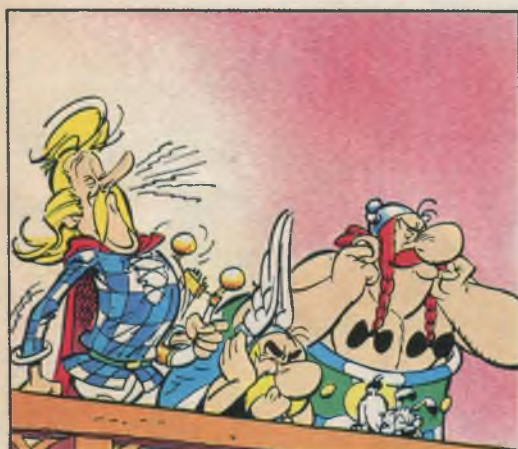
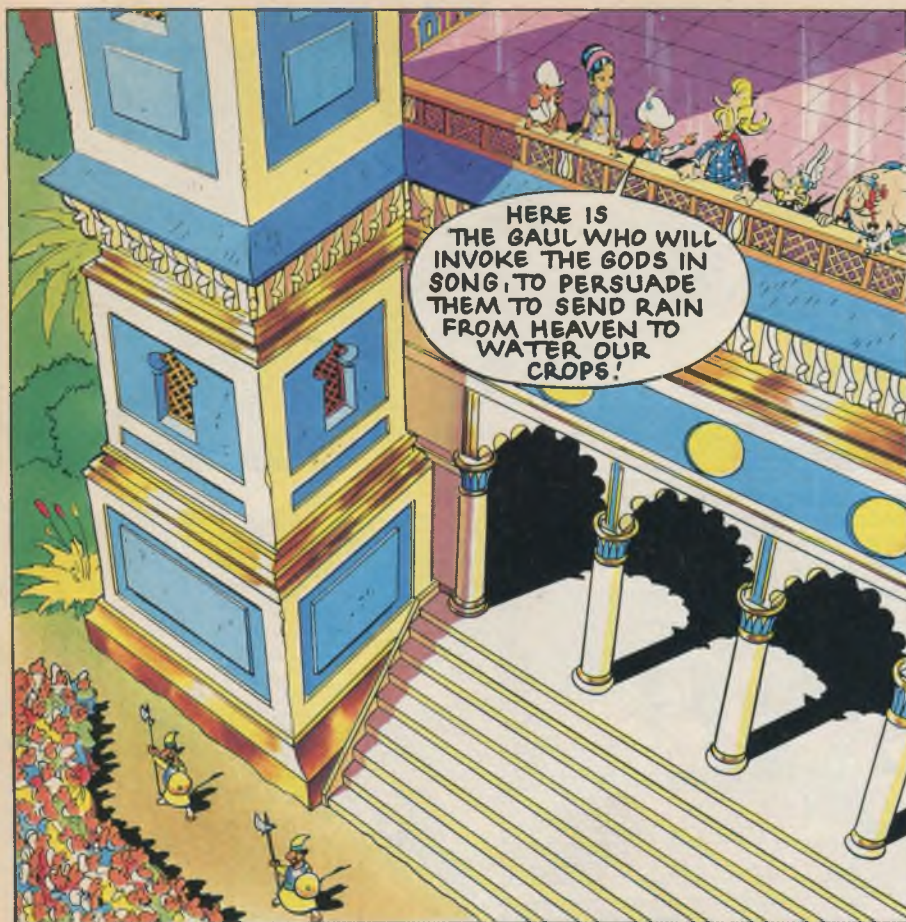
AT LAST, 30 HOURS, 30 MINUTES
AND 30 SECONDS FROM ZERO HOUR...

HERE WE ARE! THE
RIVER GANGES!

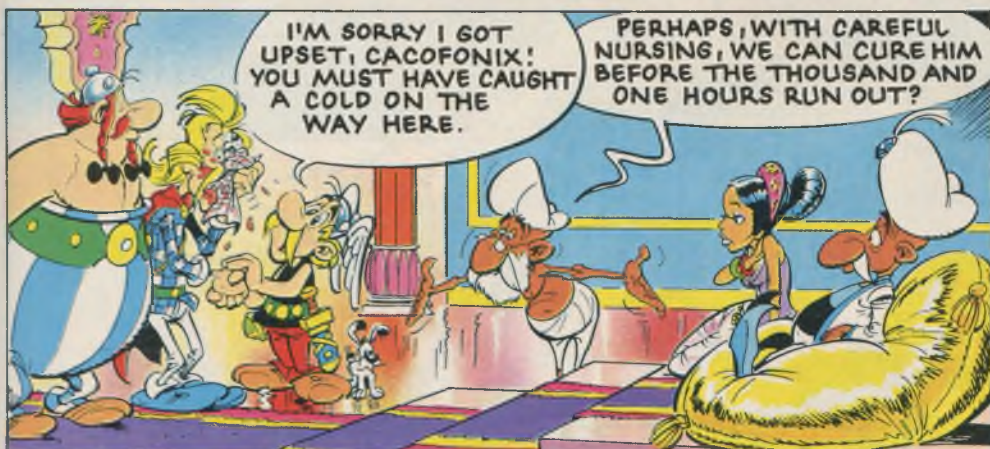




* PUT A DAMPER ON = ruin



* FACE THE MUSIC = accept the consequences bravely (i.e. there will be trouble as a result of Cacophonix's failure)



Further comprehension

- 1 Our heroes fly over a lot of countries on their way to India.

AT LAST, 30 HOURS, 30 MINUTES
AND 30 SECONDS FROM ZERO HOUR...



Can you complete this list? France, Italy, Greece, . . .

- 2 How is the architecture of Rajah Watzit's palace different from:
 - a Rome?
 - b the village of the Gauls?
- 3 From memory, can you describe what Rajah Watzit and his daughter are wearing (colours?)?
- 4 Without using the word list, can you work out what these words mean?

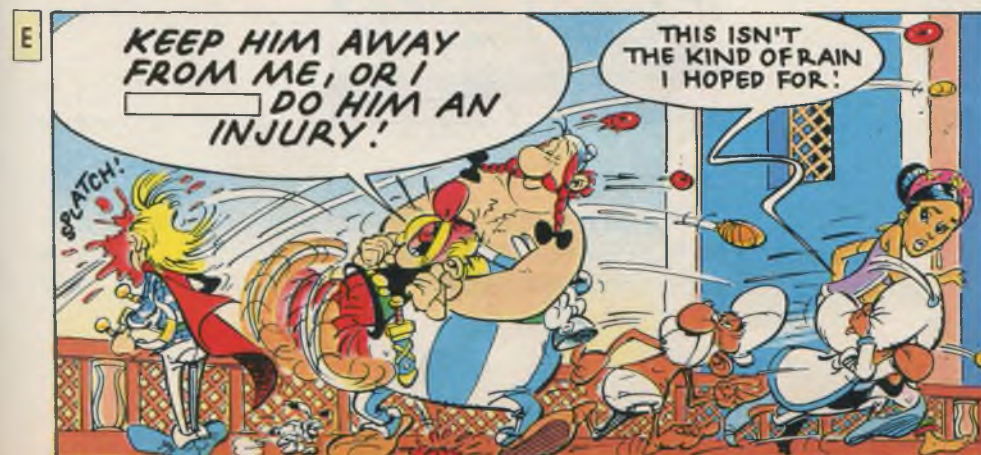
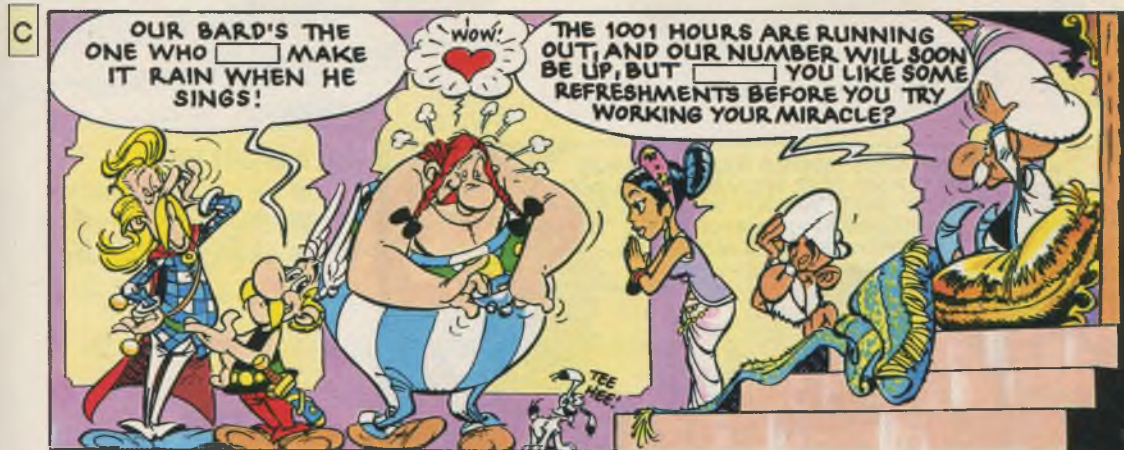
GUNGY describes the appearance of **MUD**

SQUELCHING describes the sound made when moving through mud.
- 5 What does Obelix think of the princess?
- 6 What do the Rajah's subjects think of his proclamation that 'the Gaulish miracle-worker will make it rain'?
- 7 What does the Guru Hoodunnit think of the arrival of the Gauls?
- 8 What does Hoodunnit's partner think about rain-making?
- 9 The Rajah's doctors think their medicine will cure Cacophonix. What do you think?

Modals

On page 16 we looked at some modal verbs. Here are some more. Choose words from the box to fill the gaps.

MIGHT CAN'T	MAY WOULD	CAN MUST	HAVE TO
----------------	--------------	-------------	---------



Phrasal verbs

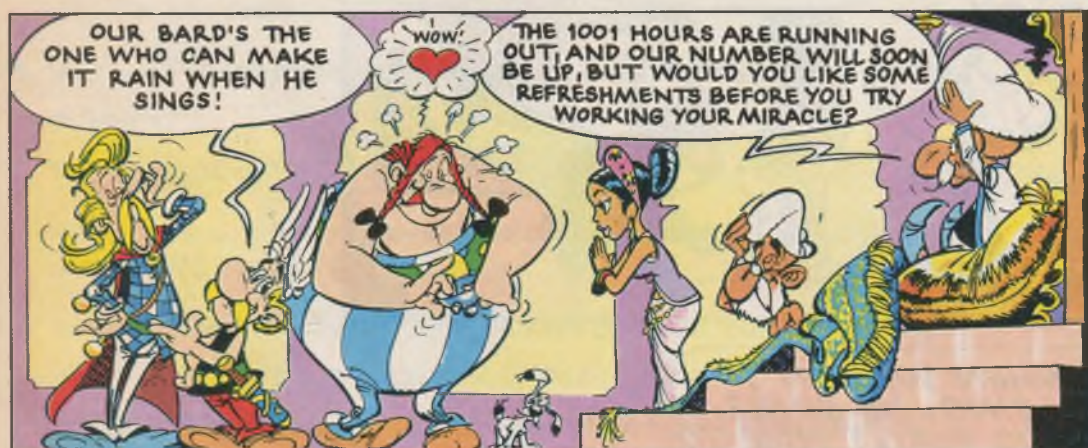
Here are some phrasal verbs.

Can you decide on their meaning from the context?



1 BE ABOUT TO (+ INFINITIVE)

- a He will brake in just a moment.
- b He might brake, he might not.
- c He is not going to brake.



2 RUN OUT (OF)

- a are going quickly
- b are nearly finished
- c are going slowly



3 PLAY UP

- a play well
- b play loudly
- c cause problems



4 PLAY UP

- a playing well
- b playing loudly
- c causing problems

Futures

- 1 There are several examples of **WILL**/**'LL** on pages 32–35. Look at them again and decide what meaning they have. For example:



WILL for prediction

- 2 In book I of this series (Asterix and Son), we saw that **BE GOING TO** can have two meanings:
- a confidence based on strong evidence
 - b strong intention, having thought about it for a while

Which meaning does this example have?



- 3 **WILL**, **'LL** and **BE GOING TO** are three ways of talking about the future.

Do you know any others?

- 4 Look at the cartoons on the following page. They each contain examples of different ways of talking about the future.

Match them to the descriptions below:

- a **IMPERATIVE** + **OR** + **IMPERATIVE** = a threat
- b **PRESENT CONTINUOUS** = a plan/arrangement (where other people are involved)
- c **PROMISE** + **TO** + **INFINITIVE**
- d **MODALS** (because they have no future form)
- e **FUTURE CONTINUOUS** = plans that cannot now be changed
- f **CONDITIONALS** (see Book 1) = talking about possibility/probability

A

MEANWHILE, FAR AWAY...

DEAR ORINJADE, IF THE FAITHFUL WATZIZNEHM DOESN'T ARRIVE IN TIME, WITH THE ANSWER TO ALL OUR PROBLEMS, THE INFAMOUS HOODUNNIT WILL CARRY OUT HIS THREAT. THE PEOPLE, FEARING FAMINE, WILL SUPPORT HIM!

I TRUST WATZIZNEHM, FATHER! HE WILL RETURN WITH THE GAULISH MIRACLE-WORKER BEFORE THE THOUSAND AND ONE HOURS ARE UP!

B

I'M CALLING A MEETING OF THE COUNCIL AT MY HOUSE. OUR GUEST CAN TELL US WHY HE HAS COME TO OUR VILLAGE!

C

WITH
A HEY DOWN
DERRY DOWN
DOWN!

AND DOWN'S
THE WORD! YOU
JUST PIPE DOWN...
OR YOU COME
DOWN!

D

WE ARE NOW ABOVE THE TYRRHENIAN SEA*. SOON WE'LL BE FLYING OVER ITALY, AND THEN GREECE, MESOPOTAMIA, PERSIA, THE VALLEY OF THE INDUS, AND FINALLY WE SHALL REACH THE GANGES.

HOW DO YOU MANAGE TO FIND YOUR WAY SO EASILY?

*PART OF THE MEDITERRANEAN

E

MY CARPET WILL NEVER CARRY ALL THAT! BUT WE CAN STOP OFF TO EAT WHENEVER YOU WANT, OBELIX.

F

AND LATER...

I PROMISE TO BRING YOUR BARD BACK VERY SOON!

OH, THERE'S NO HURRY.

YOUR SINGING WILL TAKE THEM BY STORM, CACOFONIX!

YOU THINK SO?

IT'LL BE A SMASH HIT, AS USUAL!

HERE, ASTERIX, TAKE THIS GOURD OF MAGIC POTION. IT MAY COME IN USEFUL.

THANKS, GETAFIX. ANY IDEA WHERE OBELIX IS?

5 Using some of the above, say what you think will happen

a to Cacophonix. b to Princess Orinjade.

Discuss your ideas with your partner.

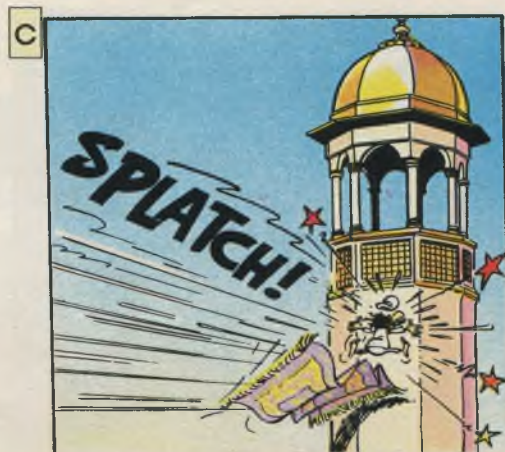
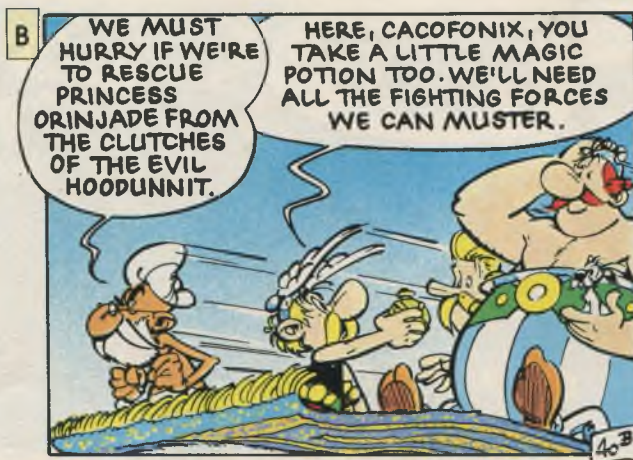


Cacophonix is left to take his medicine.

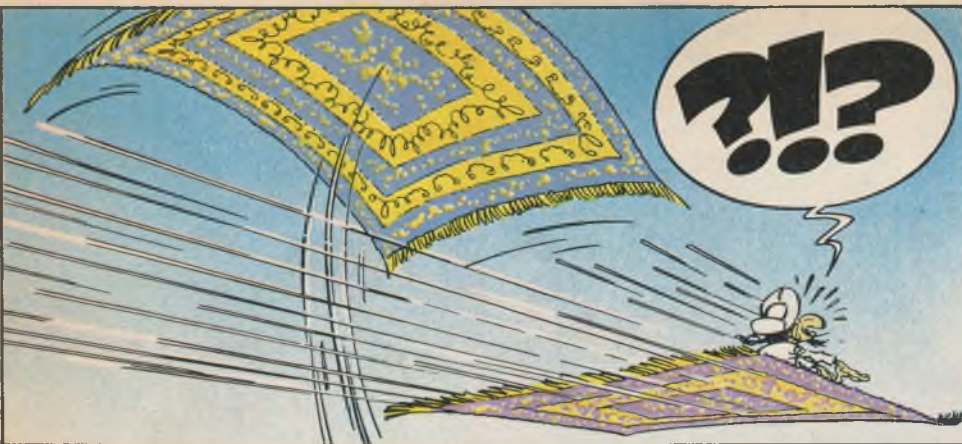
Look at the cartoons that follow and put them into the right order.

Note: Some of the cartoons are missing.

You will have to use your imagination.



D



E

AND THIRTY MINUTES
BEFORE ZERO HOUR...

I MUST
FIND THE GAULS,
QUICK!



F

AGNI*
CONSUME YOU
IN THE FIRE
OF HELL!!!

KALA**
TURN YOU TO
STONE TILL
THE END OF
TIME!!!

TOUTATIS HELP
US! THIS CARPET'S
TOO HIGH FOR US
TO JUMP OFF!



*GOD OF FIRE.
**GOD OF TIME.

G

J

NEXT MORNING, WITH TEN
HOURS TO GO TO ZERO HOUR...

TIME TO GO AND GET
CACOFONIX! IT'LL
BE QUICKER BY
CARPET!

WHAT ABOUT
MY BREAKFAST?

THERE'S A
TIME AND A
PLACE FOR EVERY-
THING!



WATZIZNEHM'S
AN OLD FRIEND
OF MINE. I'M AN
INDIAN ROPE
TRICKSTER
AND SNAKE
CHARMER!

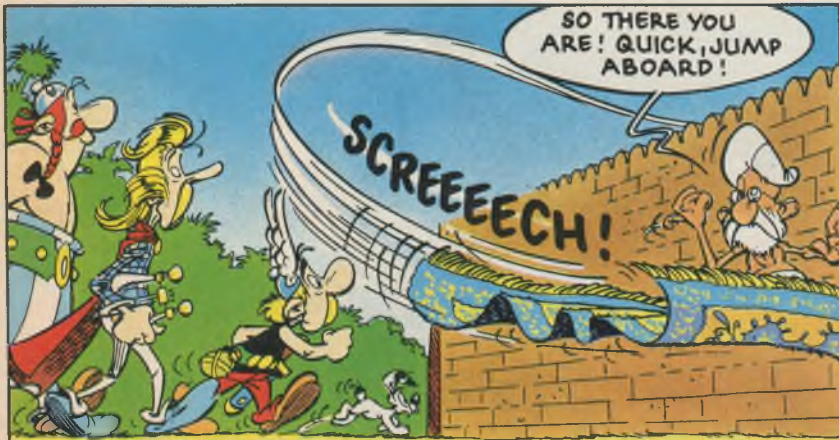
CHARMED TO
MEET YOU!



H

SO THERE YOU
ARE! QUICK, JUMP
ABOARD!

SCREEEECH!



I

THEY'RE OFF TO FETCH
THE BARD! TRY TO
DELAY THEM,
OWZAT!

THAT'S
EASY...MY
CARPET'S
PARKED QUITE
CLOSE!



1 The cartoons should follow this order:

B H E C D J A F I G

2 Here are three more cartoons that tell you what happened while Watziznehm was fighting Owzat. (They are in the right order.)

Can you complete this paragraph?

While Watziznehm and Owzat were fighting,
Asterix and Obelix went back to the place they
had left Cacophonix the night before . . .



Comparatives

1 Look at this cartoon again.

The Persian is comparing camel and dromedary (a dromedary has one hump).

Choose the answer that best describes his words.



- a tastes the same but you get more for the same price.
- b tastes the same but is more expensive.
- c you should buy it because it is better than dromedary.

2 Here are some more examples of the structure

AS

+

ADJECTIVE

+

AS

Can you complete the words?

The first one has been done for you.



a IT/CLEAR/MUD

It's as clear as mud.



b IT/CLOSE TO/OUR HUT/HERS!



c THE GODS/NOT/CRUEL/YOU SAY

(What does this expression mean?)

3 Using the same structure as in 2, can you rewrite Obelix's words?

A roast camel may be a good buy but . . .



4 Look at this use of **BETTER**.

a What does it mean?

- (i) this is a good way to go
- (ii) I think we should go
- (iii) this is a better way to go



b Can you complete the structure?

 + + BETTER + INFINITIVE
 we 'd better go

5 Using the same structure as in 4, rewrite Watziznehm's words:



Here is part of what happened while Asterix and Obelix were looking for Cacophonix.

Can you match the words to the empty bubbles?

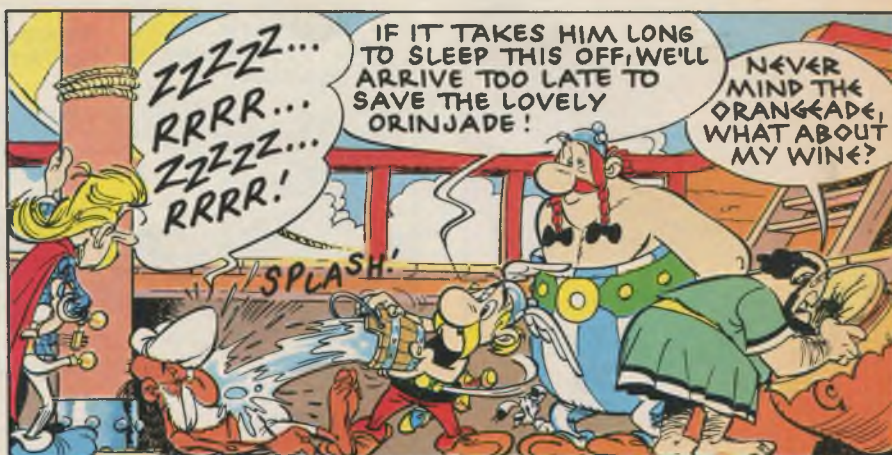
- 1 I'LL SWAP YOU YOUR FRIEND FOR TEN ELEPHANTS!
 2 ROYAL OR NOT, I BET IT ISN'T EDIBLE!
 3 HE REALLY IS VERY WELL TRAINED!
 4 DOGMATIX HAS GOT WIND OF SOMETHING!
 5 I WOULDN'T SWAP OBELIX'S FRIENDSHIP FOR ALL THE ELEPHANTS IN THE WORLD!
 6 A ROYAL TIGER !!!



Onomatopoeia

Look at these two cartoons.

1 What is the difference between **SPLOSH!** and **SPLASH!** . . . ?



2 Here are three noises a dog can make. What is the difference?



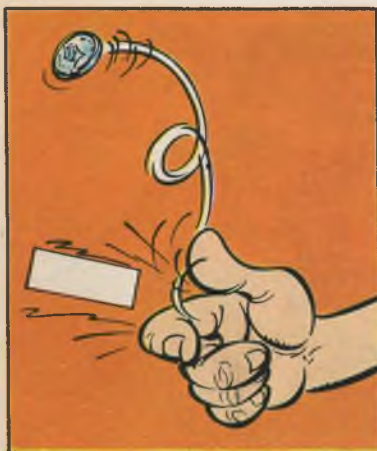
3 Here are some more sounds.
Can you match them to the cartoons?

HIC!
TWANG!

CRACK!
SCREECH!
FLICK!

CLAP!
OUCH!

A



B



C



D



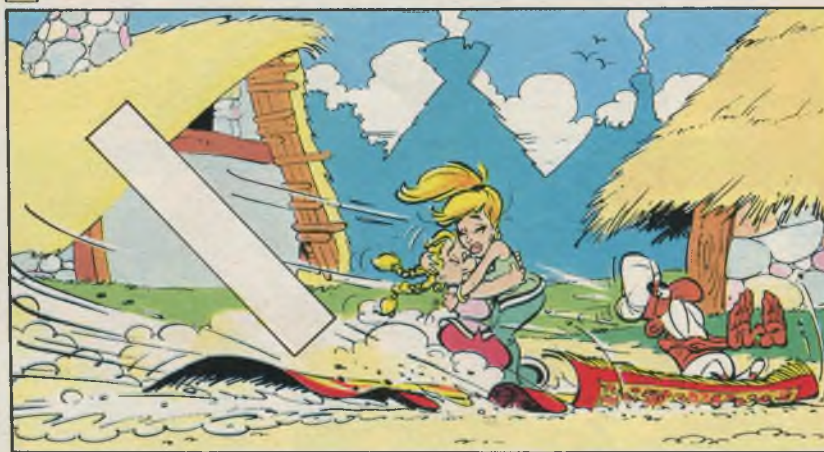
E



F



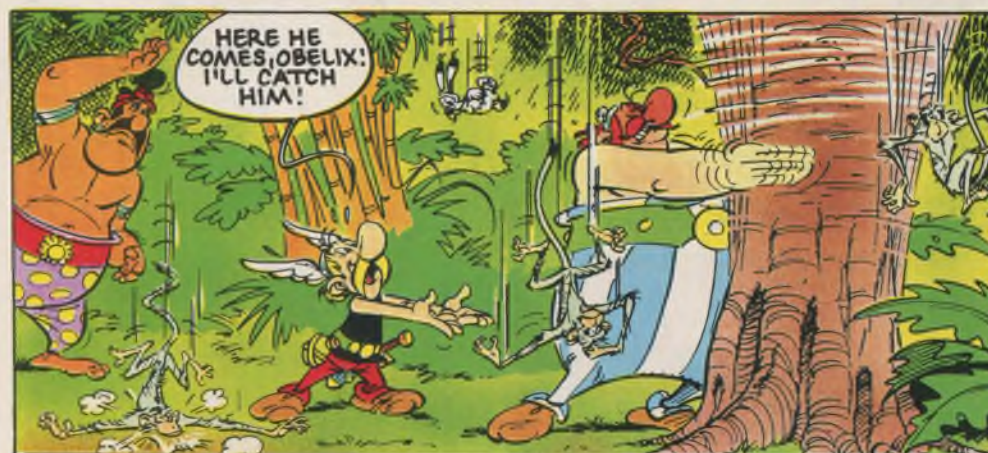
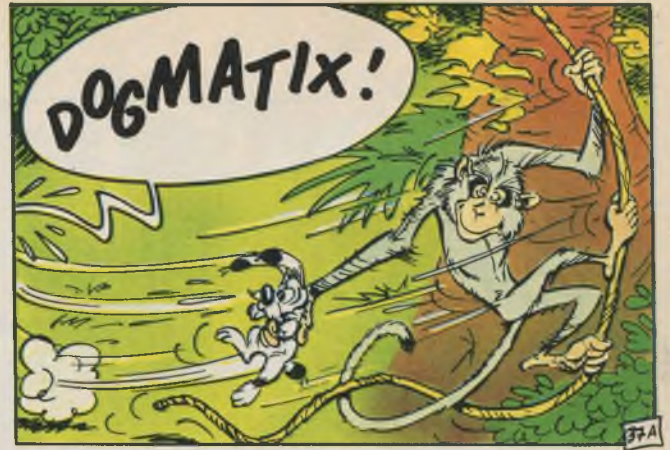
G



Dogmatix

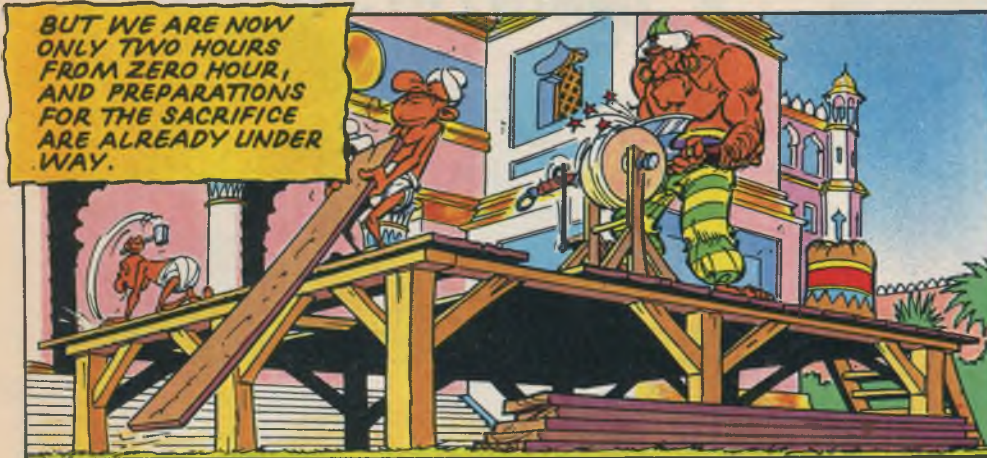
On page 5 we looked at five characters from this story. There is one other important character: Dogmatix. What do you know about him? See if you can answer these questions.

- 1 Who does Dogmatix belong to?
- 2 When the Gauls are victorious they celebrate with a banquet. What does Dogmatix do?
- 3 How does Dogmatix react when Obelix first meets Princess Orinjade?
- 4 What does Dogmatix think of Cacophonix's voice?
- 5 There is one thing that always makes Dogmatix unhappy. What is it?





SECTION 4



As you read this final extract, see if you can answer this question:

- 1 How does Cacophonix get his voice back?



AT FIVE MINUTES TO ZERO HOUR...

BETTER RESIGN YOURSELF, PRINCESS! STILL NO RAIN! YOUR LAST HOUR HAS COME!



MAY VISHNU* STRANGLE YOU, EVIL GURU!

*GOD WITH MANY ARMS.



MAY MY SACRIFICE PERSUADE HEAVEN TO SHOWER ITS BLESSINGS ON YOU ONCE AGAIN! IF IT DOES NOT, BEWARE OF THOSE SERPENTS WHO ARE TRICKING YOU FOR THEIR OWN EVIL ENDS!



LONG LIVE OUR PRINCESS WHO IS ABOUT TO DIE FOR US!!!

POOR SILLY IDIOTS!



FIVE...
FOUR...
THREE...



TWO...

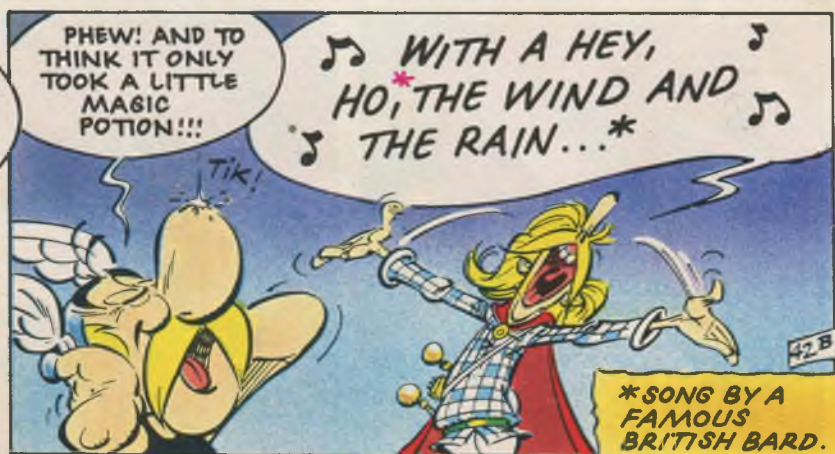
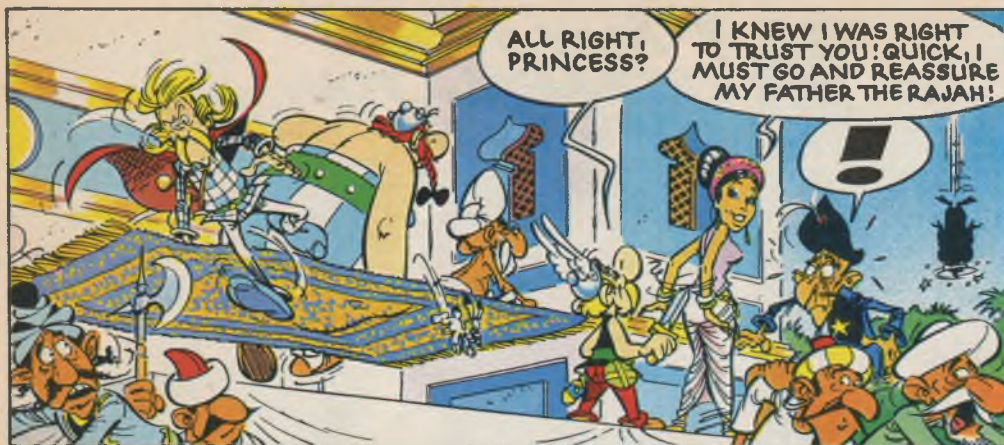


ONE...

ZERO!



TCHAC!





* IT RAIN + ETH = old English (IT RAIN + S = modern)

Further comprehension

- 1 How does the Rajah feel about his daughter's death?
- 2 How does Princess Orinjade feel about her own death?
- 3 Give the name of one Hindu god.
- 4 Look at this cartoon again.
Rewrite Watziznehm's words using one of the structures from page 38.
- 5 How do you think this adventure will end?



So and Too

Some words in English can have more than one meaning.

- 1 Look at how the word **so** is used in these two examples.

Can you explain the differences?

How would you translate them into your own language?

a **SO I AM!**
AND IF I'M
TALKING, I CAN
SING TOO!

b **DON'T BE**
SO WET!!!

- 2 Look at the word **too** in **a** above.

- a** Can you think of another word that means the same in this context?
- b** What other meaning can **too** have?

Can you find an example on page 47?

3 What is the difference in meaning between:

- a very wet
- b so wet
- c too wet

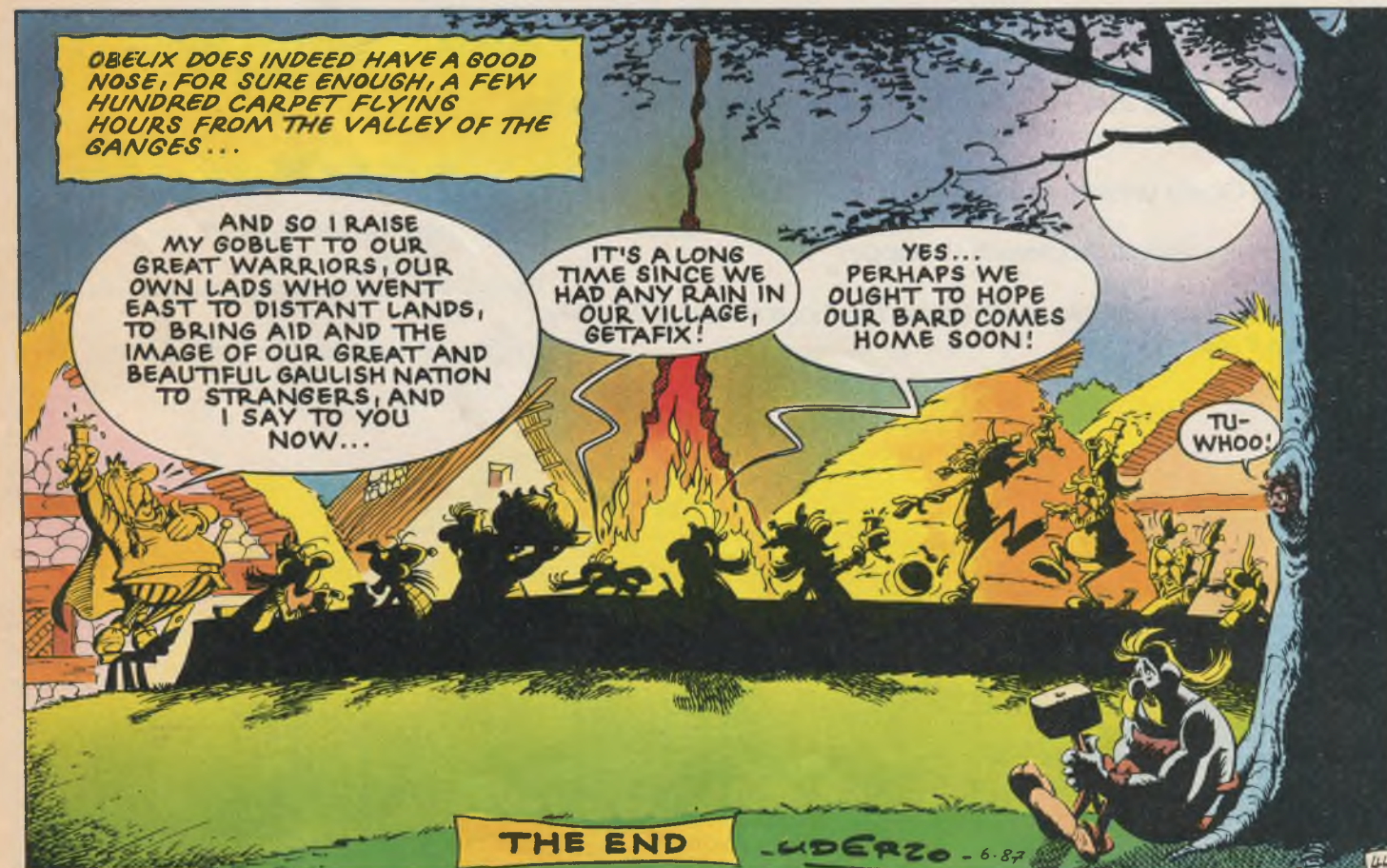
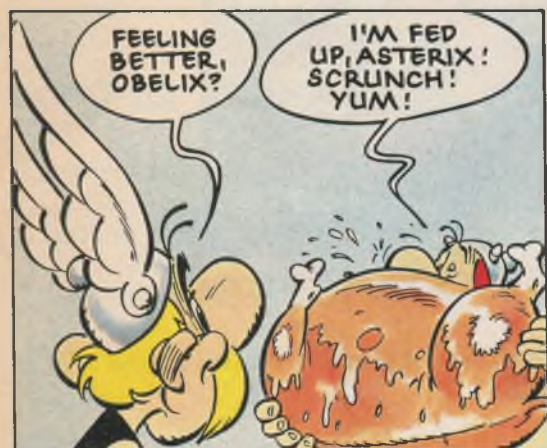
4 Look at these two cartoons.



- a How is **QUITE CLOSE** different from **CLOSE**?
- b How is **RATHER TIRESOME** different from **TIRESOME**? (**TIRESOME** = boring)

Here is the end of the story from **Asterix and The Magic Carpet**. As you read it, see if you can answer these questions:

- 1 Why is Obelix unhappy?
- 2 Why is the village blacksmith unhappy?
- 3 Find another example of **\$0** (to add to those on page 54). What does it mean?



WORD LIST

Words are listed in the order they appear in the text and are divided into two columns. The column on the left contains words you might like to remember and use.

Before looking at the word list, answer these questions:

- 1 Do you need this word to complete the task (tasks begin on page 11)?
- 2 Have you completed all the tasks that follow the extract?
(The first extract on pages 7–10 is followed by seven pages of tasks.)
- 3 Have you thought very carefully about the possible meanings?
- 4 If you are working in a group, have you discussed the meaning with your partner?

Words you might like to try and remember

Introduction (pages 3–5)

entirely (adv) completely

Section 1 (pages 6–16)

bandage (n+v) piece of elasticated cloth used in hospitals

feed (v) give food to

overcome (adj) amazed/exhausted/beaten

drop (v & n) fall/let fall

Other words

indomitable cannot be defeated

invaders people who force their way into your country

garrison guard

fortified strengthened/defended

shrewd/cunning clever at surviving like a fox

warrior a great fighter/soldier

perilous dangerous

entrusted given in confidence

brew prepare (alcoholic) drink

menhir a large standing stone like those at Stonehenge

trade job/profession

addicted cannot live without

venerable to be respected for his age and wisdom

druid wise man of the Celts

bard Celtic poet and singer

pipe down be quiet

hut small wooden house

fakir magician/wise man

senile very old and confused

stock collection

legionary Roman soldier

merchant businessman

deeds actions

retrieve get back

levitate make float/fly

be all square be satisfied

decree say

appease make happy/satisfy

wrath anger

famine no food at all

hardship great problems

magnificent splendid

Section 2 (pages 17–30)

manage to (v) succeed in

bath mat small carpet next to bath

fear (v) damage a piece of cloth by pulling till it breaks

That's torn it now we have a problem

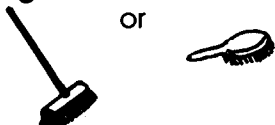
spare (adj, v & n) an extra

mend (v) repair/fix

we may have fallen on our feet we may have been lucky after all

help yourself to something take it/steal

brush (v & n) use a ... or



besides (adv) in addition to/as well as

divert change direction of

flight path direction taken by a plane

have the rug pulled out from under (us) be dropped into a problem

weave make a carpet

holler than thou to consider oneself superior morally

steal away disappear quietly/escape

pirates bandits

scythe to cut using a ...



fare food

nourishing good to eat

hump the raised part of a camel's back

Section 3 (pages 31–49)

baking (adj) very hot and dry

bitter (adj) very cold

mud (n) thick mixture of earth and water

drought (n) long period without rain

brake (v) stop a machine

trust (v) have faith in

witness (v + n) see for yourself (a legal word)

turn out (v) become

crops (n) plants growing in the fields

I'm afraid (that) I'm sorry to say (that)

injury (n) damage to a person

science fiction stories about the future and space travel

cure (v + n) make better

soak (v) sit in a liquid like a sponge

vallant brave and heroic

tirelessly not getting tired/without stopping

gungy thick and dirty

squelch noise made when moving through mud

sacred holy

purify clean

soul spirit

a lucky break lucky opportunity

curse bad words

watch your step be careful

refreshments food and drink

summoned called

make heavy weather of turn something simple into something big/a problem

patch piece of

put a damper on ruin/slow down

invoke call upon

face the music take our punishment

change your tune change your story

sheer total

keep the heat on maintain the pressure

dung animal excrement

ground crushed

Section 4 (pages 50–56)

evil (adj & n) very bad

fetch (v) go and bring back

have in common with be like

swap (v & n) exchange

be already under way be already started

strangle (v) kill by squeezing the neck

persuade (v) convince

it only took it only needed

flood (v & n) when a river or the sea temporarily covers the land

be fed up angry/unhappy

the clutches the hands

graveyard cemetery

stinking rich very, very rich

cling hold on to tightly

arouse wake up

get wind of smell/suspect

resign yourself surrender

ends plans/reasons

blasphemous offensive to the gods

inedible cannot be eaten

scrunch the sound of teeth on bone

aid help

KEY

Introduction

Page 4 The year is 50 BC. Gaul is entirely occupied by the Romans. Well, not entirely . . . One small village of indomitable Gauls still holds out against the invaders.

Page 5 Here are their descriptions from the original:

Finally, Vitalstatistix, the chief of the tribe. Majestic, brave and hot-tempered, the old warrior is respected by his men and feared by his enemies. Vitalstatistix himself has only one fear, he is afraid the sky may fall on his head tomorrow. But as he always says, 'Tomorrow never comes.'

Getafix, the venerable village druid. Gathers mistletoe and brews magic potions. His speciality is the potion which gives the drinker superhuman strength. But Getafix also has other recipes up his sleeve . . .

Cacofonix, the bard. Opinion is divided as to his musical gifts. Cacofonix thinks he's a genius. Everyone else thinks he's unspeakable. But so long as he doesn't speak, let alone sing, everybody likes him . . .

Section 1

Page 7 **1** There are six main characters, in addition to most of the village.
2 Asterix, Obelix, Cacofonix, Getafix, Vitalstatistix and Watziznehm.

Page 11 **1** He is testing the acoustics of his new hut.
2 No, not at all.
3 He can make it rain.
4 She is the chief's wife.
5 They both want to keep the carpet.
6 The little old man is married to the tall young woman who is having a fight with Impedimenta. He is annoyed because the blacksmith is laughing at them.
7 He is a fakir from India who can fly on a carpet and who can go without food for weeks. He has come to ask the Gauls for help.
8 Yes.
9 Answer on page 13.
10 a (iii) **b** (ii) **c** (ii)

Page 12 **1** when/where/what/whose
2 a and **c** are questions
b and **d** are not questions (and therefore do not require inversion).
4 b Asterix doesn't understand how the fakir can fly.
c Obelix gets upset when the fakir suggests he's fat.
d The Gauls want to know why the fakir has come to their village.

Page 13 The order should be: F E A B C D
1 There has been no rain in his country for a year and he wants to borrow Cacofonix.
2 Cacofonix can make it rain when he sings.

Page 14 **2** 'LL = an offer to help.
WILL = an order.
3 A prediction.

Page 15 **3** The apostrophe comes after the S on HOURS'.
4 in two days' time.
in five years' time.

in one hour's time.
in a few moments' time.

- 5 There is **no** apostrophe.
6 yours/ours/theirs/hers/his.

- Page 16 A **SHOULD** (**OUGHT** to is also possible.)
B **CAN**
C **COULD** (**CAN** is also possible.)
D **WOULD**
E **OUGHT TO** (**SHOULD** is also possible.)
F **MUST**

- Page 17 1 Rome
2 Cacophonix's cloak: **red**
Obelix's trousers: **blue and white**
Asterix's top: **black**

Section 2

- 1 Their carpet has a hole in it.
2 Because the Gauls protect them from the Scythians.

- Page 22 1 **MAT, RUG**
2 **a WEAVE b MEND c BESIDES d HUMP**
3 It is made of mud with flat roofs and very small windows.
The hot dry climate of Persia contrasts with the wet weather of Gaul.
4 **a** He's wearing a greenish-blue top with a yellow band, red trousers and a greenish-blue hat.
b Four.
5 The Crimea, on the north coast of the Black Sea.
6 **a AHURA MAZDA b TOUTATIS**

- Page 23 A **ALONG** (**OVER** would be possible too.)
B **TOWARDS** (**OVER** and **ALONG** would also be possible.)
C **OVER**
D **AROUND** (or **FROM**.)
E **FROM**

- Page 24 1 **b 2 No. 3 c**

- Page 25 1 **a** Passive. **b** Active.
2 Gaul is entirely occupied by Romans.
4 (**MODAL** +) **BE** + **PAST PARTICIPLE** (+ **BY**)

- Page 26 5 **a A CARPET THAT WASN'T MADE IN PERSIA**
b The preposition is different.

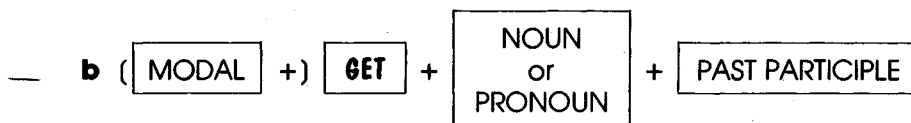
- 6 **a material/tool** **IN**

- 7 **A** He's being impersonal and diplomatic.

- B** He is forced to be more direct.

- 8 Be born in.
Be interested in . . .

- Page 27 10 **a** The word order is different and **BE** has been replaced by **GET** .



c (ii)

d (iii)

11 b The grateful Persians also have a banquet prepared.

c However, Hoodunnit is still planning to have Princess Orinjade executed.

12 c

Page 28

1 a No. **b** No. **c** Angry with himself.

2 b

3 It is contracted to **SHOULD 'VE**.

4 a (ii)

5 He feels they should have brought some food with them.

Page 29

1 D F J A G B E H K C I

2 Here is an example answer:

One day, the Gauls were visited by a Fakir from India, where it hadn't rained for a year. Although he had magic powers, he wasn't able to make it rain. So, Chief Vitalstatistix gave his permission for Cacophonix, Asterix and Obelix to set off for India on board a flying carpet. They were very excited about their new adventure but they didn't have much time to lose. While they were flying over Persia, they were struck by lightning and were forced to crash-land. However, our heroes were able to help the Persians defeat their enemies, the Scythians. In return, the Persians gave them a new carpet and roast camel with caviar.

Page 30

3 Here is an example answer:

Our heroes were flying over the sea and feeling hungry when someone shot an arrow at them. It passed through the carpet and gave Obelix a nasty surprise. The pain made him jump and fall off the carpet. His friends were horrified. This was not the end of Obelix, however. By quickly changing direction, the fakir was able to fly underneath and catch him. Obelix landed on the carpet with a bump and in a state of shock.

Section 3

Page 31

1 She has 30 hours, 30 minutes and 30 seconds left.

2 He has lost his voice.

Page 36

1 France, Italy, Greece, The Lebanon, Syria, Iraq, Iran, Afghanistan, Pakistan, India

2 Domes, minarets and decorative features contrast with the formality of Rome's classical architecture. The effect is made even lighter by the use of bright colours.

The Rajah's palace is built in a hot and sunny land where large, open spaces keep you cool. The Gaulish huts are small and dark and made with poor materials like rough stone and thatch.

3 The Rajah is wearing a white jacket and trousers with blue edging, a black sash, blue sandals and a very large turban which has a sapphire on the front.

The princess is wearing a purple jacket with white edging, white trousers, a pink headband and jewellery.

4 Check your answers against the word list on page 58.

5 He thinks she is extremely beautiful and feels very embarrassed at meeting her.

6 They are very sceptical.

7 He's afraid they will ruin his plans.

8 He doesn't believe it's possible

Page 37

A **CAN ... MAY**

B **MUST**

C **CAN ... WOULD**

D **CAN'T ... HAVE TO**

E **MIGHT**

Page 38 1 a 2 b 3 b 4 c

Page 39 2 a
4 a C b B c F d E e D f A

Page 44 1 a
2 a IT'S AS CLEAR AS MUD. (It's not at all clear.)
b IT WAS AS CLOSE TO OUR HUT AS HERS!
c THE GODS ARE NOT AS CRUEL AS YOU SAY.

Page 45 3 ... BUT IT'S NOT AS GOOD AS ROAST BOAR!

4 a (ii) b  + HAD + BETTER + INFINITIVE
5 WE'D BETTER GO BY CARPET. (IT'S QUICKER.)

Page 46 a 4
b 6
c 2
d 3
e 1
f 5

Page 47 1 SPLOSH! is used for the sound of lots of water.
SPLASH! is for smaller quantities of water.
2 WOOF! is the sound of a dog barking.
SNIFF! is the sound a dog makes when smelling something.
Dogs HOWL! when they are unhappy.

Page 48 3 A FLICK! B CLAP! C OUCH! D TWANG! E HIC! F CRACK! G SCREECH!

Page 49 1 Obelix.
2 He's given a big bone to chew.
3 He laughs at Obelix's embarrassment.
4 He has the same opinion as everyone else (see page 34).
5 He hates to see trees being destroyed.

Section 4

Page 50 1 He drinks some magic potion.

Page 54 1 He believes she is going to die for nothing. He thinks Hoodunnit is lying about the need for a sacrifice and that he is scheming.
2 She accepts she must die and hopes that her death will bring the rain her people need. However, she is aware that she might be the victim of a trick and warns the crowd to be careful of Hoodunnit.
3 VISHNU
4 JUST WHAT I WAS GOING TO DO
1 a It is true. b To such a degree.
2 a Also. b An excessive quantity.

Page 55 3 a A lot of water.
b I am surprised at how much water ...
c An impossible quantity of water.
4 They don't carry much meaning at all. They simply water down the meaning of the adjective that follows. QUITE CLOSE means the carpet is a little further away than CLOSE but still close enough to be convenient. RATHER TIRESOME means the situation is a boring problem but not as boring as TIRESOME

- 1** Because he's missing the banquet back at the village.
- 2** Because he's missing Cacophonix
- 3** **AND SO I RAISE MY GOBLET ..'**
= therefore

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